

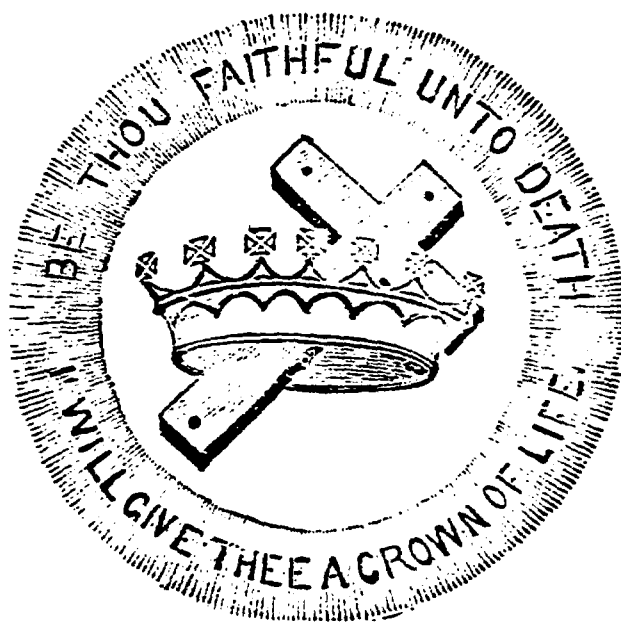
A SKETCH
OF
THE WINTERS FAMILY.

EDITED BY
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IN compiling this sketch the editor has made free use of material found in the issues of the *Dayton Daily Journal* and the *Dayton Daily Herald*, and desires in this manner to make due acknowledgments. Also to express his obligations to Rev. Isaac H. Reiter, Rev. J. P. Hentz, and Mr. B. H. Winters, for the valuable information which they furnished.



TO
My Wife,
THIS SKETCH OF A FAMILY
TO WHICH
SHE VENTURED TO ALLY HER FORTUNES,
IS
 Lovingly Dedicated.

PREFACE.

IN the following pages we propose to give a sketch, as far as our limited information will permit, of that branch of the Winters family to which we belong, so that our contemporaries, and those of the same name that come after us may learn something of the stock from which they sprang.

A lack of family records, running back of the time of the landing of our ancestors on the soil of America, together with the uncertainty attending the date of its occurrence and the reason of it, opens up a vast field for the play of the imagination, the exercise of which might interest the lovers of romance, but could not satisfy the demands of history. In order, then, that we may not become entangled in its byways, nor lost in its labyrinths, we shall put on the "bit and the curb" and pull ourselves up with a "round turn" whenever we wander too far.

The name of Winters is not a common one, not in the sense that it is either exclusive or celebrated, but in the fact that it is not often met with outside of our own recognized family connection. One seldom meets with it in his travels, and it is still less often met with in history, so that when it does crop out in the pages of the latter, whether

connected with unusual and extraordinary events or not, its very appearance sets going a train of thought and conjecture which will not "down" at our bidding.

By searchers after pedigree, history is looked upon as a help only, and not as being capable of furnishing a complete solution. It supplies dates, names, and incidents to a certain extent, but beyond this it cannot go, and there yet remain great mountains to be leveled, and vast chasms to be filled in, such as might well appall the most enthusiastic genealogist. As a class, however, they do not permit such small obstacles to restrain them in their career, but follow up their allotted task with amazing coolness, and deal with mountains as though they were mole hills, and vast canyons as sluice ditches. While it is true that the nature of the leveling required, and the conditions of the filling used lack the mathematical accuracy which is required in other things, they do not regard this as an insuperable objection, and shelter themselves from adverse criticism behind the greater latitude permitted in such a search and use the trifling incidents and coincidents, which follow the name down through generations and nationalities, to prove their inferences and establish their deductions.

To show the extent to which this absurd method of proof might be carried with the subject in hand, it is only necessary to call attention to two startling events mentioned in English history, which may, or may not, have had an influence on the family whose history we have undertaken to write.

The first of these occurred during the latter part of the reign of Queen Elizabeth. It was the great battle for supremacy and religious freedom fought between the

then two greatest powers of Europe, England and Spain, in which the English navy dispersed, and, aided by heavy storms, almost destroyed the so-called "Invincible Armada" of Spain. History tells us that Lord Henry Seymour and Sir Thomas Winter were in joint command of one of the English squadrons, and that they did their duty bravely and well. There is nothing, however, in this incident for us to dwell on, save a coincidence connected with the name of Thomas Winter, which will manifest itself further on.

The next incident occurred during the reign of Elizabeth's successor, James I. It was the infamous "Gunpowder Plot," and we are told that Robert and Thomas Winter were active participants in it. Failing to accomplish their design of blowing up both houses of parliament and the royal family, they were exposed, captured, and, by due process of law, executed. Neither is there anything in this, however, that will weigh in the balance either for or against us, but a coincidence, which the name, Thomas Winter, suggests. Nothing more, nothing less. We do not claim to be in the line of descent from either the brave Admiral or the bigoted conspirators, but, in order to bring out a singular coincidence in names, we call attention to the further fact that, about one hundred and fifty years later, there was born in Holland Thomas Winters, the known and recognized head of our branch of the Winters family. Said Thomas Winters emigrated to America and settled in Maryland, and there his only son, Thomas, was born. One of his sons, born in Ohio, was also named Thomas. To a casual observer it would seem that Thomas was a family name, and had been handed down from generation to generation.

Now, there is nothing to connect the English family of Winter with the American family of Winters, except the coincidence above named, for it is known that the American family are descendants of emigrants from Holland, and no traditions have been handed down to show that either family were ever other than strangers to each other. Is it not strange, therefore, that the name Thomas Winter should crop out in the only two instances in which we can find the name of Winter mentioned in history, and that the same name, with only an added "s," should descend from father to son, beginning in Holland about one hundred and fifty years ago, and coming down to Ohio in our own time? Does not such a string of coincidents appeal strongly to the imagination?

In view of the above it is barely possible, though not at all probable, that Sir Thomas Winter, of "Armada" fame, was the father of Robert and Thomas Winter of the "Gunpowder Plot," and that, after their execution, their children, being deprived of their property and persecuted as Roman Catholics, fled to Holland, the customary asylum of English political refugees, and there established the family from which five generations later the recognized head of our branch of the Winters family sprang. Five generations, covering about one hundred and fifty years, is, however, rather an extended period to bridge over without piers or trestle work, and with but little in the way of abutments to support the superstructure.

Then, again, the English family rejoiced in the name of Winter, while the American family are full-blown Winters; the English were Roman Catholics of a bigoted type, while the Americans are pronounced followers of

the "Reformation." If we could bridge the one hundred and fifty years with one solitary strengthening pier, and then reconcile the slight difference in name, and the vast difference in the religious belief of the two families, we might be able to erect a family tree of respectable proportions; but, as the facts stand, we cannot.

Should we, however, waive all these difficulties and put up a family tree of mammoth proportions, and adopt for our escutcheon one of those marine monstrosities of "good Queen Bess's" time, called galleys, or that other horn of the dilemma consisting of a cellar, three barrels of gunpowder and a lighted torch, with Guy Fawks in the background, how can we reconcile this conclusion with a legend, or what purports to be one, which has been whispered around in the family of late years? It is to the effect that our family name is purely of modern origin, and was originally in Holland not Winters but Van Triage, but that it had been in some unknown manner changed or corrupted into Winters. Whether changed purposely or in ignorance, or whether changed at all, we have not been able to obtain any evidence further than the prevalence, to a limited extent, of the legend in question, and all attempts to follow it to its source were futile, and proved it to be the veriest will-o'-the-wisp.

We shall settle down, then, to this conviction, and rely upon it as veritable history, that the ancestors of our branch of the Winters family, whether named Winter, Van Triage, or Winters, were emigrants from Holland; but why they came to this country, or when, or where they first settled, there are no records within our reach to show.



The Winters Family.

I.

IN Harbaugh's Valley, Frederick County, Maryland, on the 23d of December, 1778, a son was born to Thomas and Rebecca Winters, who, in honor of his father, was duly christened Thomas. This little episode occurred during a period of great political darkness and gloom, as Maryland, with the other American colonies, was then engaged in a stupendous effort to cast off the yoke of Great Britain, and few there were, in that sequestered valley, to forecast the result of the struggle. Thomas was the first and only child of his parents. When only fifteen days old his father died, "hence his early training devolved upon his mother, who appears to have been a woman of much force of character and piety, and fitted by nature and grace for the solemn trust committed

to her care. Her counsel and example, during his childhood and early youth, no doubt largely directed and influenced his subsequent life."

After an interval of years, Rebecca Winters, being still quite youthful and yearning for companionship, abandoned her widow's weeds and made a second matrimonial venture. The happy groom was Jacob Harbaugh, a farmer, who lived high up in the mountains of Maryland. As Harbaugh had no children then, and as there was no issue from this marriage, Thomas, as the only child of the household, became quite a favorite with his step-father, who, at his death, made him the heir of his small savings. It speaks volumes in favor of that kind-hearted man, as to the nature of his treatment of the half orphaned boy, that, when a half century later, the writer of these chronicles asked the eldest son of that boy for the name of his grandfather, the answer he received was "Jacob Harbaugh!"

Of the circumstances of the early life of Thomas Winters we have little to record. No doubt but that the life he led was much the same as that of other youth similarly situated in mountain fastnesses. To compel an unwilling subsistence from the rocky soil of those elevated regions meant days

of labor, privation, and unceasing vigilance, but their nights brought cool, pure air and sweet, refreshing slumber, and their recompense came to them in stalwart forms and robust characters. Perhaps it was then, as he followed his daily round of duty and contemplated the majestic beauty and solemn grandeur of the mountains, that his thoughts were raised from the study of nature to nature's God, and the inspiration came which impelled him, in after years, to go forth and preach to erring and sinful humanity the blessed gospel of the Son of God.

"He seems to have been religiously inclined from his earliest youth, and this state of mind deepened and strengthened as he advanced in years. In his fifteenth year, he, after being instructed in the doctrines and duties of the Christian religion, was received into full communion of the Reformed Church by the Rev. Jonathan Rahauser, then pastor of the Hagerstown" and other outlying congregations.

"A few years after his religious impressions became deepened through the earnest preaching of the Rev. William Otterbein, then pastor of the Reformed Church in Baltimore, and who occasionally preached in Washington County, Maryland,

where Thomas Winters then resided. Being of an ardent temperament and full of zeal, he not only became very active in the cause of Christ, but was naturally drawn into the current of the then prevailing religious awakenings and excitements, and was gradually induced to lead some of the devotional meetings and also occasionally to employ his gifts in exhortation." "Naturally endowed with a good mind, he gradually so improved it by persistent effort and application as to acquire a very commendable degree of knowledge and establish his character as a leader and minister, and, in course of time, came to be regarded as one of the best and most instructive ministers of his day. He continued to study the Bible and to exhort until the twenty-second year of his age, when, with a view to promoting his usefulness, he was licensed to preach by Rev. William Otterbein and other Reformed ministers."

While thus growing mentally, physically, and spiritually, and just prior to his majority, another and all-powerful influence was brought to bear upon him, which had no small share in shaping his future life. A near neighbor, the Rev. Valentine Flegle, who was also of the Reformed faith, rejoiced in the possession of a charming daughter,

to whose attractions Thomas was anything but indifferent. Whether his "itineracy" always took in the Flegle homestead, and his exhortations began and ended at this juncture, with the fair Susannah as his only auditor, we are unable to affirm positively, but as human nature is much the same the world over, we suspect that such was the fact. However this may be, Thomas, with his ardent temperament, pressed matters to an issue, obtained the consent of the not unwilling girl and her parents, and was joined with her in wedlock on the 26th of February, 1799.

Susannah Flegle was born on the 6th of May, 1782, and was consequently under seventeen years of age when she was married. She was an affectionate wife, loving, kind-hearted, and cheerful, and imparted her sunny nature to all about her. In the subsequent labors of her husband she proved to be a "helpmeet" worthy of him. She lived with her husband in the unalloyed happiness of wedded bliss, sharing with him his toils, privations, and journeyings for a period of over fifty-four years, till her death, which occurred on the 8th of March, 1853, at Evansport, Defiance County, Ohio. She lived to see her children's children and their children, but her death was a

blow to her husband. from the effects of which he never recovered.

The fruits of this marriage were twelve children, whose names, dates of birth, and to whom married, are as follows: Mary, born November 21, 1799, and married to John Schaeffer; David, born December 24, 1801, married to Mary Ann Huffman; Jacob, born March 2, 1804 married to Catharine Blunt; Margaret, born July 2, 1806, and lived only ten days; Valentine, born July 8, 1807, married to Catharine Harshman; Susannah, born January 24, 1810, married to William N. Schaeffer; Thomas H., born October 12, 1812, married to Harriet Hivling; Catharine, born April 5, 1815, married to John Garber; Christina, born December 12, 1817, married to John Eichelberger; John Peter, born January 18, 1821, married to Maria Alexander; Matilda, born April 24, 1824, married to William Robinson, and Ann Margaret, born April 22, 1827, and died May 25, 1836.

We have no definite records of the early movements of Thomas and Susannah Winters other than the places of the birth of their children would indicate. Mary, the first child, was born in Frederick County, Maryland; the second child, David, was born in Martinsburg, West Virginia,

while Valentine, the fifth child, was born in Clearfield County, Pennsylvania, and the children following him were born in Greene and Montgomery counties, Ohio.

Rumors of the beautiful country and fertile soil of the lands lying between the Miami rivers in the then Northwest Territory, having penetrated to the quiet home of Thomas Winters, he, about the year 1800, started west on an exploring expedition, "with the view of gaining a better knowledge of the new country." He journeyed on foot from his home in Maryland to Pittsburgh, and from thence descended the Ohio River in a small boat and disembarked at the mouth of the Little Miami River, and from there continued his journey on foot to Xenia, and thence to Dayton. After spending about six weeks in this region of the Northwest Territory, in "inspecting the country in regard to its physical and moral condition," besides doing missionary work as occasion offered, he took up his journey homeward, carrying with him, no doubt, a mental resolution to return, at no distant day, and bring his family with him.

Soon after his return to Maryland, he removed with his family to Martinsburg, Berkeley County, West Virginia, but only remained there about two

years and then returned to Maryland. A few years thereafter he removed to Clearfield County, Pennsylvania, where he continued his evangelical labors in connection with teaching and farming.

In the meantime the State of Ohio had been apportioned off from the Northwest Territory and was growing rapidly, and, as Thomas had not ceased to remember his visit to the Miami Valley, he became more and more impressed with the idea of removing to that favored spot. After consulting his "beloved wife and obtaining her consent," he, in the fall of 1809, set out with his family and household goods for this land of promise. His realty he had traded for "pig iron," as that section of country abounded in iron ore, and this he sold, part in Pittsburg and the remainder in Cincinnati. The journey was a long and weary one for a family of six, of which the youngest, Valentine, was but two years old. Mountains had to be crossed, and valleys traversed, and rivers overcome, but he persevered and at length reached his destination without serious mishap, and located in "Beaver Creek settlement," in Greene County, "having for his residence a log cabin."

"He now at once engaged in his evangelical or missionary work with earnestness, preaching on

Sundays, mostly in private houses and occasionally in a forest grove, and teaching school during the week days. He did not confine his ministerial labors to the "Beaver Creek settlement" or the immediate vicinity, but gradually extended his efforts to other places at a distance. His services became appreciated by the people, and, as his work was extended, his influence and usefulness increased." In this way he labored for several years, and then moved and settled on a school section in Mad River Township, Montgomery County, near the then thriving village of Dayton.

Here he remained for a number of years and devoted himself to farming, teaching school, preaching, and to the education of his large and still growing family.

"About this time the Christian world was disturbed by a religious movement, which resulted in the establishment of a separate body, bearing the name of the 'United Brethren in Christ.' Of this he writes: 'During this time I was strongly urged to go into the organization of a new church, called the United Brethren in Christ, which was then in process of formation, and which actually did come into being, but, like the good Otterbein, whom I greatly loved and esteemed for his piety

and talents, I preferred to live and die in the Reformed Church.'"

At this time "the German Reformed Congregation, at Germantown, Montgomery County, Ohio, desired that he should become their pastor, but their constitution required that the pastor should be a regularly ordained minister and a member of the Reformed Synod. To comply with their requirements, he went to Easton, Pennsylvania," where the Reformed Synod convened, and was by it, on the 25th of April, 1815, duly licensed to preach.

From Easton "he went to Philadelphia and purchased a number of books, which were specially adapted to aid him in the further prosecution of his studies, and, after a brief sojourn, returned to his distant home in the West, feeling that he was better equipped for the important work before him." In the fall of that year he removed with his family to Germantown, "which now became the center of his subsequent operations, and was regularly installed as pastor of the Reformed Church. He entered upon the discharge of his duties with full 'purpose of heart,' laboring with diligent perseverance, and extending his field until it embraced parts of the counties of Montgomery,

Preble, Warren, Butler, Greene, Miami, and Hamilton. He was 'abundant in labors,' serving at times as high as seven and eight congregations, besides some missionary points."

In the early fall of 1819 he again visited Pennsylvania for the purpose of attending a meeting of the Reformed Synod, which held its session that year at Lancaster. "Here before a committee of Synod he passed a final and approved examination," and on the 9th of September, 1819, was duly ordained to the gospel ministry, and soon thereafter returned to his ministerial labors in Ohio.

The principal congregations served by him were as follows: "Germantown (1815-1840), Springboro (1816-1836), Schleiffer's (1817-1840), West Alexandria (1817-1840), Lewisburg (1817-1840), Bear Creek (1820-1826), Beaver Creek (1820-1824), St. Peter's (1827-1833), Evansport, Defiance County, (1840-1842), and other points for a year or two. In serving these he labored hard, traveled much and proved himself a sturdy and successful pioneer minister." "He was a man of good, practical sense, and became a well-informed theologian, had a good gift of language and a ready delivery, was a faithful pastor and an effective preacher. His preaching was of an earnest, faithful, and

searching character, and he was indefatigable in the work committed to him." "He possessed a peculiar talent of influencing and controlling men," and "was also of a most pacific and conciliatory temper and turn of mind." "But above all, he was a man of unquestioned Christian integrity, enjoying not only the confidence of his own parishioners, but of all others with whom he was brought into contact." "He preached with 'equal facility' in both the German and English languages, and had a class of four or five young men who were studying for the ministry, among them his two sons, David and Thomas H., and continued active in church work until his retirement" in 1842.

The following incident in the good parson's career has come down to us, which illustrates not only the hardships, but the disappointments of pioneer ministers. On one occasion he was summoned to a distant part of the county to perform a wedding ceremony. It was in the late fall; the distance was about twelve miles; the roads were submerged in mud and water, and added to this a cold, disagreeable rain was falling. The journey was made on horseback, and there and back consumed the day, and it was late at night when

he again reached his home. His good wife was improving the time, whilst awaiting his return, mending some rents in the children's garments. Approaching the table at which she sat, he threw upon it, with almost boyish delight, a single Mexican dollar as the fruit of the day's exposure. (Silver dollars then were so scarce that they seemed as large as "cart-wheels" in the eyes of the recipient, hence the parson's delight.) The good wife, noticing something peculiar about the ring of the metal as it struck the table, picked it up and examined it curiously. After sounding it again and again upon the table, she said, with rather a hollow laugh: "Why, father, this is counterfeit." And so, indeed, it proved, much to the parson's dismay, turning his day of toil into one of disgust and discomfiture, but only drawing from him the remark that he "was afraid that a wedding so begun would end disastrously."

In the year 1840, he, with the remaining members of his family, removed to Evansport, Defiance County, Ohio, and remained there till after the death of his beloved wife, when he went to live with his son, John P., in West Alexandria, Preble County, Ohio, where he died October 2, 1863. He was one of the connecting links between two great

events in the history of this country—the War of the Revolution and the War of the Great Rebellion. As he was born during the birth throes of the nation, so eighty-five years later he died during the early portion of its great struggle for continued existence.

“For the last twenty years of his life he lived mostly retired, not being able to preach regularly or to serve a pastoral charge. The weight of years and infirmity began to press heavy upon him, and he experienced at times much suffering. His extensive labors, extraordinary exertions and frequent exposures in inclement weather brought on extreme physical debility and a general prostration of the system, but his interest in the cause of Christ was not abated to the last.”

Well might this good old man exclaim in the words of the apostle Paul, as his end drew near, “The time of my departure is at hand. I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith: henceforth there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give to me at that day.”

His remains and those of his wife were brought to Dayton and buried in Woodland Cemetery.

II.

VALENTINE, the third son of Thomas and Susanah Winters, was about eight years old when the family removed to Germantown. It was in this classic village that he acquired the rudiments of an English education, under the tutelage, first, of his father, and later on of his brother David, who had himself received his instruction from his father. His father's school was held at George Emrick's, about one mile north of Germantown, while his brother's school was held within the village limits. In this neighborhood he took his first lesson in the piscatorial art, and, no doubt, spent many hours in shady nooks bordering on the "Big Twin," angling for chubs, shiners, and sunfish, or, when he had outgrown these, for the gamy bass. Near here, also, with gun in hand, he traversed the surrounding forests in search of the sportive squirrel, obtaining, at rare intervals, snap shots at woodcock, quail, and wild turkeys. Had he not loved these sports Germantown would have disowned him, for the true Germantowner is noted for his strict attention to business, and, with him, the word business means hunting and fishing;

all else is considered pleasure, and pleasure is tabooed. It can be no surprise, then, to those who remember the surroundings and teachings of his early years, that this love of sport should survive sixty years of active business life and crop out so strongly in his latter days.

In the meanwhile he was growing in stature and knowledge, and the time soon came when the yearnings, usual to youth of his age, to obtain employment and thus become self-supporting, beset him with unusual force. He was anxious to help his father, who was struggling to support his large family, and who, no doubt, found it difficult, with the small salaries then doled out by village and country churches, to make both ends meet. His first employment was in the brickyard of Isaac Robertson, at ten cents a day, and we are told that there are still standing, in and near Germantown, houses and chimneys which he helped to construct.

It is said that there is "no royal road to knowledge," and Valentine soon found that, although a minister's son, his position in the brickyard was no sinecure. What with working all day, through the hot months, under a broiling sun whilst mixing the clay, and that, too, while in constant dread of

Note:

Recordings in the Herschman (Harchman)
family, prove that the name
Andrew Harchman, pages 32, "Winter Fam",
should read Matthias, or more
fully Matthias Ulrich Herschman.

He came to Anacostia, is buried in
Beaver Run Cem., Mineral Co., N. Va. stone
still standing (1964) marked MAH 120 yrs. 1801.
(with)

the hoofs of a vicious ox, and then through the early spring and late fall to be exposed to the rain and frost, and, coupled with this, later on, expected to do a man's work for a boy's pay, gave to this mode of life, to one of his active and ambitious temperament, an unbearably galling aspect. He realized that he was equal to better things, and resolved to make an effort for their attainment.

At the close of a hot summer day, when he had reached his home footsore and weary, and aching at every bone, he wrote to his brother David, who was then located in Dayton, to endeavor to procure employment for him in one of the business houses of that place. The distance to Dayton was not great, and the mail soon brought back the joyful intelligence to that anxious boy that the efforts of his brother had been successful. A place had been secured for him at a salary of fifty dollars per year and his boarding, in the dry goods store of Andrew Irwin, which was then situated on the west side of Main street, across the alley from where the new court house now stands. This amount of salary, over and above his living expenses, seemed like a bonanza to a boy begrimed with brick dust; the news was almost too good to

be true, but he believed it, and rejoiced accordingly. Following rapidly on the heels of his rejoicing came his doubts and difficulties. He had not consulted his parents. Would they let him go?

In this dilemma he thought first of his mother, (what boy does not?) and immediately sought her presence to obtain not only her consent to his going but her influence with his father, that he might obtain his also. O, these darling, darling mothers! how we can, each one of us, look back to the time when we presumed on that mother love either to obtain some much longed for object or to shield ourselves from the justly aroused wrath of the household's head. "Why, Valentine, you must be crazy, you are too young, you will never make a storekeeper!" ejaculated this good mother, in her first outburst of fear and alarm. "I can try, mother," said the boy, "and if I fail, Dayton is not so far off but what I can walk back."

She was soon won over—mothers usually are by the eloquence and earnest pleadings of their sons,—and with her assistance who can doubt the result? "He is but a boy, barely eighteen, and without experience," the husband urged, but the united pleadings of the wife and son proved too

much for the kind husband and father, and he yielded as gracefully as he could to the pressure.

Then came the separation. The parents, the brothers and sisters, the home to be left behind, and a launching out into the unknown. Who looks back, however, when siren-visaged hope is beckoning him onward? The kiss of parting was given, the tears were shed, and the boy went out from that home forever.

His journey to Dayton was on foot and without incident, and he was welcomed by Mr. and Mrs. Andrew Irwin with open arms. They were very kind to him, and while one inducted him into the mysteries of trade, the other took charge of his moral and social life, and, by precept and example, taught him to avoid the snares and quicksands which beset young men in towns and villages. She gave him that oversight which is so efficacious and enjoyable when coming from a cultivated and refined woman. It is related that, as he was at one time escorting her from church, he stumbled in the darkness, and, failing to recover his equilibrium, fell flat upon his face. "Tut, tut, tut, Valentine," said she, "you are a nice gallant." This estimable woman was the sister of Col. Jefferson Patterson, the mother of Henry L. and

R. P. Brown, and A. Bar. Irwin, and latterly the wife of Horatio G. Phillips, whom she survived many years.

At the close of his two years' engagement with Mr. Irwin, Valentine obtained employment with Harshman & Rench, who were then engaged in a general merchandizing business at the northeast corner of Main and Third streets, at a salary of two hundred dollars a year and his boarding. He then took up his quarters in the family of John Rench, the junior partner of Harshman & Rench.

Whilst still in Mr. Irwin's employ he had, in company with Edwin Smith, Samuel Bacon, and Jephtha Riggins, taken advantage of a beautiful Sabbath day to attend the annual meeting of Shakers, held at Shakertown. Young Jonathan Harshman was there in attendance upon his sister Catharine. Edwin Smith, being somewhat facetiously inclined, and scenting fun in the denouement, offered to bet our youthful merchant a dollar that he could not obtain the privilege of escorting Catharine Harshman to her home. The bet was eagerly taken, and Valentine sought and obtained an introduction, found favor in the fair maid's eyes and won the dollar, much to her brother's disgust, who, when the happy couple had mounted their

horses and taken the homeward path, followed moodily in the rear.

Among the customers whom it became his duty to serve, after entering the employment of Harshman & Rench, was the fair Catharine, the subject of the above pleasantry. No doubt but that she often found occasion to visit the store, and between them much time was spent in discussing the qualities of the articles she desired to purchase. Whether their fingers met whilst examining into the intricacies of laces and embroideries, and by this means the electric spark was kindled, or whether they only cast "sheep's eyes" at each other as the bargain was being made, has not been disclosed, but this much is certain, that Valentine became a Sunday visitor at the Harshman mansion, and that the heart of at least one member of that household beat more quickly at his approach, and tell-tale blushes announced the conquest he had made.



III

ANDREW HERSCHMAN, the great-grandfather of Catharine Harshman, was born and spent his life in Germany, though in what portion we are not informed. He lived to the extreme age of one hundred and twenty years, and had had, at successive intervals during the course of his long pilgrimage, five wives, Catharine being descended from the third wife. Christian Herschman, the grandfather of Catharine, and the son of this long-lived and many-wived Teuton, was born in Germany on the 22d of April, 1744, and came to this country when a mere lad. He settled in Frederick county, Maryland, and later on married Catharine, the daughter of a neighboring farmer. She, Catharine, was born on the 15th of June, 1752, but whether a native of this country or not, we have been unable to ascertain. The children of this marriage were as follows: John, Ann Maria, Esther, Philip, Christian, Jonathan, Susannah, Catharine and Christina. It was a happy union, and they seem to have prospered in a worldly point of view, as Christian's last will and testament, a copy of which is before us, indicates that

he had accumulated a fair estate. He died on the 26th of October, 1816; his wife Catharine survived him for a number of years.

Jonathan, the sixth child of Christian and Catharine Harshman, was born on the 21st of December, 1781, near Frederick, Maryland. In 1805, he, with others from the same neighborhood, emigrated to Kentucky and located temporarily in the "Blue Grass Region" near Lexington. Here he remained for about a year and then returned to Maryland. He took back with him a number of horses, which he had purchased during his sojourn, and from the sale of which in the East, he hoped to realize a fair profit. The result of this venture has not been handed down. During the following year he made a second visit to the "Blue Grass Region," but, not desiring to locate permanently in a slave State, remained there but a short time. He then came to Ohio and settled in Mad River Township, on a farm now owned by his grandson, George Harshman, and, later on, purchased the property which became the site of Harshmanville.

It seems to have been the custom then, as it is now, for the rural gentry, living contiguous to Dayton, to make weekly visits to that pleasant village to dispose of surplus products, purchase

needed supplies, and gossip a little with neighbors who had come for a similar purpose. On one of these occasions, he and some of his young friends had their attention called to a party of immigrants, newly arrived, who were camping on the site now occupied by the public library building. Following the custom of the country they went over to bid them welcome, and possibly to glean the latest news brought from beyond the mountains. The immigrants proved to be the family of John and Elizabeth Rensch, who had come from Maryland with the intention of settling in this county. Whether the news received met the expectations of these young men we are unable to say, but tradition tells us that one of their number, Jonathan Harshman, found something there vastly more interesting than stale Maryland gossip, and that his eyes lingered long and tenderly on the person of Susan, the fair daughter of John and Elizabeth Rensch.

The attraction seems to have been mutual, for we find that, after John Rensch had continued his journey to and settled in Salem, in this county, he was soon followed by bachelor Jonathan with serious intent. The family received him so kindly, and Susan gave him such a cordial welcome, that

he felt encouraged to repeat his visits. This he did, and the result was their marriage on the 18th day of February, 1808. The bride, Susan Rench, was born on the 11th of November, 1786, in Washington county, Maryland.

The children of this marriage were as follows: Elizabeth, born November 17, 1808, and married to Israel Huston; Catharine, born January 4, 1810, and married to Valentine Winters; Jonathan, born February 15, 1812, and married to Abigail Hivling; Mary, born January 17, 1816, and married to George Gorman; John Rench, born November 6, 1818, and died August 31, 1819; Joseph, born October 24, 1820, and married to Caroline Protzman; George W., born February 22, 1822, and married to Ann V. Rohrer; Susan, born May 22, 1823, and married to Daniel Beckel; Reuben D., born January 16, 1827, and married to Mary Protzman.



IV.

ALL this time, however, we have been permitting the love passages of Valentine and Catharine to grow cold, but, when we recall the fact that not only "Barkis is willin'," but all the parties interested, what other result than marriage could follow? So it came to pass that, on the first day of January, 1829, at the residence of the bride's parents, in Mad River Township, Valentine Winters and Catharine Harshman stood up and "in the presence of God and these witnesses" pronounced the irrevocable vows which made them husband and wife. The ceremony was performed by the Rev. David Winters, brother of the groom, and the attendants were William Clark and Sarah Suman, who were themselves, shortly afterwards, united in the holy bonds of matrimony. After a sumptuous wedding breakfast the happy couple and their escort, consisting of William P. Huffman, Samuel Bacon, William Clark, Sarah Suman, Julia Darst, and Christina Darst, mounted their horses—the bride's being a white one and the groom's a dark bay—for a wedding trip to Germantown, the home of the groom's parents.

What a pleasing spectacle it must have been to the good citizens of Dayton, as they gathered at their doors and windows and watched the cortege go by. Their route lay along Third Street to Perry, and thence to the river ford, below Sixth Street. It was not the day of "Tally Ho's" or "brass bands," but, lacking these, by following the customs of the country, the party was none the less happy. It was a crisp, sunshiny, delightful New Year's day, and, no doubt, that mid-winter ride to Germantown remained green in the memories of the participants to their dying days.

Then, again, who can tell the extent to which the quiet village of Germantown was stirred by the return of the "prodigal?" Only this one reversed the order and went out on foot and alone, but came back on prancing palfrey, with colors flying, mounted attendants, and a bride, and not from the "husks" and the "swine." Who can portray the joy of that good village pastor and his wife when they "lifted up their eyes" and saw their son coming to present them, in the old homestead, with another daughter? No doubt but that the "fatted calf" was killed, and the best raiment brought out, and joy and gladness reigned supreme in that household. The party remained over night

at Germantown, and on the next day returned to Harshmanville.

The wedding journey ended, the festivities over, and the honeymoon passed, the newly married couple began to take life seriously and removed to Dayton. They set up house-keeping in a brick building, on the southeast corner of Third and Jefferson streets, on the site now occupied by Huston Hall.

They began this new life with rather a serious drawback for those days. It was a debt the groom contracted for his wedding outfit, and amounted to nearly forty-seven dollars. It is doubtful whether the bride was advised of this rash expenditure till after the wedding, for her abhorrence of debt was so great that there is no telling what the consequences might have been had she known it. However this may have been, they both now set to work with a will and managed, out of his salary of two hundred and eighty-five dollars, to pay the said debt and all of the household expenses, including their clothing, and to have a surplus at the end of the year of over thirty-eight dollars. Who can tell the amount of toil and self-sacrifice represented by this small sum? and yet how cheerfully endured by hearts and hands when they work

lovingly and loyally together. We suppose that if the truth were really known this sum looked larger to them then and gave them greater satisfaction than many of the thousands they accumulated afterwards.

During the year there had been an accession to the family. On the first day of October Susannah was born and was the occasion of much rejoicing in that small household. How the hearts of parents swell over their first born with the sacred feelings of fatherhood and motherhood and the highest sense of ownership, realizing that if naught else is theirs this new born child is.

Out of a salary of three hundred dollars for the second year, 1830, he was able to pay all of the expenses of himself and family, amounting to one hundred and ninety-one dollars, and after adding the remainder to some other outside earnings, to set aside, at the close of the year, two hundred and fifty-one dollars toward the building of his first home. This was shortly afterwards built on Jefferson Street, immediately south of where he then lived, on the site now occupied by Beckel Hall.

At the commencement of the third year his prospects brightened. In recognition of the zeal he manifested in his employers' interest, and his

thorough business qualifications, they gave him an interest in the business and continued it under the firm name of Harshman, Rensch & Co. As a sort of supplement to this dawning of a brighter day, he was still further favored, on the 28th of January, 1831, by the birth of a daughter, Martha Jane. With this increase of fortune, his expenses also materially increased. They amounted to three hundred and seventy-two dollars. His dignity as partner, two children and a new house drew heavily on the exchequer, but his share of the profits of the firm was more than sufficient to meet the emergency.

On the 27th of October, 1832, another diamond was added to his casket of jewels in the birth of Mary Eliza.

In 1833, the German Reformed Congregation of Dayton was organized by the Rev. D. Winters. There were six original members, whose names are as follows: Catharine Harshman Winters, Mary Ann Winters, Mr. and Mrs. Abraham Artz, and Mr. and Mrs. Valentine Fryberger. Later on Valentine Winters, Frederick Boyer, and Peter Baer were elected trustees.

The cup of rejoicing of Valentine and Catharine was filled to overflowing on the 21st of October,

1834, by the birth of their first boy, who was duly named Jonathan Harshman in honor of his maternal grandfather. Two years later, on the 29th of October, 1836, a second son, Charles Henry, was born unto them, but only lived till November 23, 1837, when he fell a victim to that dread scourge, the scarlet fever, but not, however, until he had entwined his young life into the hearts of the whole family. On the 18th of January, 1839, the fourth daughter, Catharine, was born to the further enlivenment of an already lively family.

The next year the family removed from Jefferson Street to the south side of Third Street, between Ludlow and Wilkinson streets, to the site now occupied by the old homestead. The house into which they moved was torn down in 1852, and the present stately edifice erected, which was completed and occupied in 1854.

In the early morning of the 16th of February, 1841, this most fortunate family was visited with a double blessing in the birth of twin sisters, Laura and Clara, whose resemblance to each other then, and for many years afterward, was so complete that it was difficult for their friends, without close scrutiny, to distinguish one from the other. On the second of February, 1843, George H., the third

son, was born, and on the same date, two years later, Reuben, the fourth son, put in his claim for family recognition. And, lastly, on the 27th of November, 1846, Alice, the "pet" of the household, came. Thus there had been born to Valentine and Catharine Winters seven daughters and four sons, all but one of whom lived to reach their majority.

In the meantime, on the 5th of December, 1839, Susan Rench Harshman, the beloved wife of Jonathan Harshman and the mother of Mrs. Valentine Winters, had died and been buried in the family burying ground in Harshmanville.

V.

ABOUT the year 1840, Jonathan Harshman retired from the firm of Harshman, Rench & Company, and the business was continued thereafter by the remaining partners, under the firm name of Rench & Winters. This firm occupied two rooms for the carrying on of their now extensive business--one situated on the northeast corner of Main and Third streets, and the other on the north side of First Street, east of the canal basin, for the canal did not then extend across First Street. In connection with these branches of

their business they operated a line of boats on the canal; a pork-house, which was situated in the rear of the First Street store, and a slaughter-house situated north of Water Street, about where Wight's lumber yard is now located.

Conducting their various enterprises in concert proved quite profitable for a while, but in the end came near causing their financial ruin. The passage of a national bankrupt law by Congress, August 19, 1841, found consignments of Rench & Winters, consisting of pork and lard, in nearly every town of the least importance along the banks of the Ohio and Mississippi rivers from Cincinnati to New Orleans. Through the operation of this law these consignments turned out to be almost total losses. The whole southwestern country had been largely overtraded and its merchants were, as a rule, in a precarious condition, so that, when said law was passed for the relief of insolvent debtors, its provisions were almost universally taken advantage of, not only by the weak and shaky ones, but by many who could and ought to have paid their debts dollar for dollar. It proved such a convenient way to wipe out a troublesome indebtedness in order to begin again fresh with the world, that few could resist its allurements.

Seemingly worse to Rench & Winters than the insolvency of their consigners were the annoying official notices of their bankruptcy with which they were flooded by almost every mail. Each letter cost twenty-five cents, double letters fifty cents, and the recipient was compelled to pay the postage. To lose the claim and then be obliged to pay twenty-five or fifty cents for official information of said loss seemed to them like adding insult to injury, or like the added "straw" which "breaks the camel's back." It did not have that effect, however, for Rench & Winters, though staggering under these repeated losses, were not men to sit down and mourn over their misfortunes, but rather were aroused to renewed energy and pushed the other branches of their business so successfully as not only to retrieve their losses, but to make an additional gain.

It is related of them that, at one of the darkest hours of this period, when both parties were feeling that the heavens above and the earth beneath were conspiring against them, they took a drive to the country to visit and consult with their old partner, Jonathan Harshman. It was a beautiful morning of the early summer, all nature was clothed in its loveliest garb, and the murmur of

the brooks, the sighing of the wind amidst the leaves, and the music of song birds from the neighboring trees, seemed to exercise a potent influence over their minds as they journeyed, and to lift them above their present troubles. As they drove along and quietly took in the beauty of their surroundings, Mr. Rench broke the silence by saying, in his emphatic way: "Winters, though all things seem to combine against us and our business prospects were never so blue, the birds still sing, the squirrels bark, the grass grows, while above our heads the grand old sun is still shining. All nature laughs, why then shall we despond? We have lost much, to be sure, but we have not lost all. We still have health, and strength, and energy sufficient to overcome the effects of this disaster. What more can we ask?" So these two men, while thus communing with nature and each other, put off their burdens and took up their work.

Toward the close of 1843, Rench & Winters concluded that their business was sufficiently large and its branches varied enough for them to separate, so that each partner could take the branch or branches to which he was best adapted. The division of interests was made on amicable terms

by the partners whilst sitting on a fence near Springfield, where they had gone to examine a mill property on which they had a claim. Mr. Rench took the canal boats, the pork and slaughter-houses, and the First Street store, while Mr. Winters took the Main and Third Street store and other outside property. This division of interests made in this off-hand way, it is claimed, proved as satisfactory to both parties as it would have done had they labored over it for weeks.

The entire time of Mr. Winters was now devoted to merchandizing. Every spring and fall he visited Philadelphia, and sometimes New York, to make purchases, and frequently staged it the entire way. It was the day of "Concord coaches," those vehicles which contained more misery to the square inch for the weary traveler than any other in which the writer has ever traveled. They were then, with their gay colors, pale leather lining, crimped trimmings, and dangling leather tassels, considered altogether luxurious in their appointments, while the speed with which they were hustled through the country by numerous relays of well-fed horses, made them the favorites of the traveling public.

By this mode of travel he had, from the begin-

ning to the close of his mercantile career, crossed and recrossed the Allegheny Mountains sixty-four times. On one occasion, when he and Mr. Joel O. Shoup, also a Dayton merchant, (merchants usually traveled in pairs), reached Baltimore on their homeward journey, they found that all the seats in the west bound coaches, for the eight following days, had been engaged. To remain in Baltimore for eight days was not to be thought of, so they started out on a tour of observation, and after gathering such facts as would serve them best, proceeded to interview the stage agent. After a lengthened interview with him, they ascertained the fact that, by closely packing and consolidating the baggage of the different coaches which were to start out that day, the "boot" of one of them could be emptied. This the agent agreed to have done for them, and they engaged it, and, strapped in under the heavy leather apron as baggage, they rode in the boot of a coach for two days and two nights until they reached Wheeling. As the boot was large and roomy, and they had a plentiful supply of straw to lie on, they both agreed that this was the most comfortable stage ride that they had ever had, and that the only inconvenience they suffered from was when the stage stopped for

meals, to be compelled to wait until the driver should be at leisure to unbuckle the straps and let them out.

On another occasion, whilst ascending the Allegheny Mountains in a blinding rain storm, the driver became confused, drove off the road, and the coach was thrown down the side of the mountains. After making more than one revolution, its course was arrested by a large tree, against which it rested. One can imagine the alarm and confusion reigning within that coach, every seat of which was occupied. In the midst of the confusion one man, having stentorian lungs, bawled out "Help, help, I am killed," but after being carefully extricated from the coach, was found to be entirely unhurt. So many had been hurt and needed attention that when this brawler's condition was ascertained, the unhurt passengers were so indignant that they were with difficulty prevented from inflicting condign punishment upon him.

Mr. Winters was not conscious of any hurt until it came his turn to clamber from the coach. The stage lay on its side; and when he attempted to reach up to pull himself out, he found that he could not use his right arm. After being assisted from the coach, it was discovered that his collar bone

had been broken. This accident occurred near the town of Hancock, in Maryland. He was taken to a neighboring farm house, where his broken bone was set by the surgeon of the stage company. Here he remained for eight or ten days until his shoulder got so that he could travel. The stage company then furnished a carriage to take him through to Brownsville, on the Monongahela River. Soon growing tired of the slow movements of the carriage, he abandoned it for a coach at the first opportunity. In this last conveyance he had safely reached Uniontown, when the driver, a veritable "Jehu," in making the grand sweep in front of the hotel, took too short a turn and upset the coach. This proved a sorry accident for Mr. Winters, as his collar bone was again fractured. He had it immediately reset, however, and continued his journey to Brownsville. Here he thought his troubles were over and took passage on a stern-wheel steamer for Cincinnati. The "stern-wheeler" was one of those loose-jointed affairs that shake continually, as with the ague, so that his collar bone was again shaken from its moorings. As there was no surgeon on board, he was compelled, to his great discomfort and pain, to continue his journey in this condition to Cincin-

nati, and, not wishing to stop over there for surgical help, proceeded by canal boat to Dayton. Here Dr. Henry VanTuyl was called in, who, after examining the fracture and learning its history, made the following consoling remark, "Well, old fellow, you will have a time of it." The good doctor, however, bandaged him so skillfully that he falsified his own prediction, for the fractured collar bone soon healed and gave Mr. Winters no further trouble.

During one of Mr. Winters' trips down the Ohio River from Pittsburgh, there was another Daytonian on board the steamer, one Mac, a shoemaker. He was bringing back with him from the "East" a supply of leather. In order to reduce his expenses to the minimum, he was traveling as "deck passenger." In consideration of a largely reduced fare, deck passengers were expected to help "wood up" at the wood stations, and to assist in taking and putting off freight at the various landings. As Mac was not nearly so fond of work as of cheap passage, he made it a point, whenever the steamer stopped for wood or freight, to slip off into the town or the adjoining woods and loiter there till the whistle gave the signal for departure; then he would

suddenly appear and step quietly and unconcernedly on board. The captain soon "caught on" to this little trick of Mac's, and with a grim smile, bided his time. The occasion sought for soon offered in the shape of a wood station bordering on an immense forest. The steamer pulled in to it, and the captain began bargaining for the wood and Mac disappeared in the forest. This disappearance was the signal for prompt action on the captain's part, for he ordered the lines to be cast loose, sounded the whistle for departure, pulled out into the stream and continued his journey, totally ignoring Mac's importunate shout from the wharf, "Passenger left. passenger left."

This is the same individual who was appealed to by one C——, a prominent and exemplary citizen of Dayton, to have his (C——'s) measure taken for a pair of shoes. This gentleman was noted for his large feet. Mac measured one of them carefully, and duly recorded the measurement on a slip of paper. He then studied the figures for a moment, and then the feet of his would-be customer. He then took a second measurement and compared it with the one previously taken, and, after again examining the feet of his puzzled customer, said quietly, "I can't make your shoes, sir."

"But I want them," said the now astonished C——, "and you must make them." "I can't do it, sir," said Mac, firmly. "Why not? I'll pay you your price," said C——. "Because," said Mac, "I should be a pretty fool to *spoil a whole side of leather for one pair of shoes!*" And make them he would not.

VI.

In this year, 1845, Mr. Winters was largely instrumental in organizing the Dayton Bank, under the independent bank law of the State of Ohio, of which he was elected cashier, and Jonathan Harshman, president. Although his banking career begins here, he did not withdraw from the merchandizing business, but continued it under the firm name of Winters & Schaeffer, he having taken one of his clerks, Thomas Schaeffer, who was also a nephew, into partnership with him, to whom he confided its management.

In January, 1848, Mr. Winters bought out Mr. Schaeffer's interest in the store, and then confided its management to James B. Dicks, as confidential clerk, which position he retained till the spring of 1857, when Mr. Winters sold the store to David

W. Winters and retired from the merchandizing business.

Whilst Mr. Winters was cashier of the Dayton Bank the law called for a yearly examination of the banks of the State by an official appointed by the governor. On one occasion a Quaker, living in the southern portion of the State, came into the bank and informed Mr. Winters that he had been appointed by the governor to examine the Dayton bank, and at the same time presented his credentials. "Very well," said Mr. Winters, "where will you begin the examination, with the money or with the books?" "Do I have to count the money and examine the books, friend Winters?" he asked, with astonishment. "Yes, that is your duty," replied Mr. Winters. "Well, I'll tell thee what it is, friend Winters, I don't know anything about money or books, but if thee will just make me up a complete statement of the condition of the bank, I will certify it to be all right."

Mr. Winters was cashier of the Dayton Bank from its organization till the fall of 1850, when he resigned and John B. Chapman was elected in his stead.

At the organization of the Dayton & Western Railroad Company, August 31, 1847, Valentine

Winters was elected a member of its board of directors, which position he still holds, and was, by the board, made treasurer of the company. It was largely through his instrumentality, in devising ways and means and furnishing cash supplies, that the company was ultimately successful in pushing its way from Dayton to the Indiana State line, its point of intersection with the Indiana Central Railroad Company.

He had, also, from its organization, been director and treasurer of the old Firemen's Insurance Company, and he still occupies those positions in the reorganized company of to-day.

As a member of the "Safety Fire Engine and Hose Company" he did efficient service in those good old days, when every citizen felt it to be a duty to belong to one or the other of the fire organizations of the city, and, whenever the church bells sounded the fire alarm, to don their gaudily painted tin hats and run with the engine. This was before steam fire engines and a paid fire brigade had monopolized the service. There was much rivalry between the companies as to which should be able to reach and throw first water on the fire, and, not infrequently, the slogan of "Safety" and "Independent" disturbed the "quiet

ear of night." But this rivalry was more often a generous one, and seldom found expression in unseemly contention, and the service was so gallantly performed as to save our city from many, and, no doubt, serious conflagrations.

We will now turn from these details of an active and busy life to an event about to transpire in the family of Valentine and Catharine Winters, which is interesting in the highest degree. The air is heavy with the sighs of orange groves, and the fragrant odor of its blossoms permeates the old homestead. A wedding is to disturb the monotony of births, and the second break is to occur in the family fold. Susannah, the fair-haired first born, after pluming her feathers for flight from the parental nest, exchanged vows, on the 10th of January, 1849, with Napoleon B. Darst, and "they two became one flesh." The wedding occurred in the evening, in the presence of a large number of assembled friends and relatives, and the attendants were Johnson V. Perrine, William Dixon, Martha Darst, and Martha J. Winters, a sister to the bride. The ceremony was performed by the Rev. David Winters, uncle to the bride. Mr. Darst had been born and raised in Dayton, and was at this time junior partner in the firm of Perrine & Darst.

This firm engaged largely in the wholesale dry goods business, had a large and profitable trade, and enjoyed excellent credit.

The children born of this marriage were as follows: Charles W., married to Anna Babbitt; Catharine W., married to E. C. Fuller; Johnson Perrine; Mary, married to Joseph E. Bimm; Samuel, married to Jessie Mauzay; Frederick, and Rollin S.

During the following summer the Asiatic cholera broke out with exceeding virulence in Dayton, and, rapidly overspreading the city, hurried many victims to an untimely grave. Among them was a nephew of Mrs. Winters, Jonathan H. Huston, who was then clerking for Mr. Winters and boarding in his family. In less than five hours from his first attack he was a corpse. How other members of Mr. Winter's family escaped the dread scourge, when thus brought into their midst in epidemic form, is one of those problems for which there is no accounting. The mortality in the city was so great, and the consequent alarm so prevalent, that every branch of business, except, perhaps, that of the baker and undertaker, was paralyzed. The editor of these papers, who then took young Huston's place in his father's store, had little to do during those long summer months, other than cut-

ting off mourning goods and counting the passing funerals. These generally consisted of the hearse, with sometimes one or more attending carriages. Farmers refused to bring in supplies, but, as all vegetables were tabooed, whether wisely or unwisely we do not know, this was no great hardship, as we could send out for butter and eggs. The cholera continued its ravages until cut short by the frosts of winter.

On the 31st. of March, 1850, Jonathan Harshman, the father of Mrs. Winters, died after a lingering illness. His career had been a singularly successful one. Almost everything that he put his hand to prospered. As farmer, distiller, miller, merchant, banker, and capitalist, the record is one of almost unvarying success. A Dunkard by descent, and yet not a member of that body, he lived outside the pale of church creeds, was scrupulously honest and conscientious in all his dealings, and held himself accountable to God only for the deeds done in the flesh. He left a large estate to be divided amongst his children, and that better legacy, a good name. His remains were interred in the family burying ground in Harshmanville.

About three months later, June 27, 1850, Martha

Jane, the second daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, joined hands with Robert R. Dickey, in the presence of a small number of relatives and friends, and pronounced the vows which made them man and wife. The ceremony was conducted by the Rev. David Winters, and the attendants were Jasper Jennings, John P. Comly, Anna Coblentz, and Susan H. Rench. Mr. Dickey was born on the 26th of October, 1816, in Butler County, Ohio, and was at the time of his marriage a member of the firm of Dickey, Shafer & Company, who were largely engaged in quarrying Dayton marble, and to whom belongs the credit of building and operating the first railroad running out of Dayton. It was a framework of wood, the stringers being used as the rails; the cars were low and flat, and propelled by horse or mule power. This tramway began on East Third Street, just beyond the second canal bridge, and ran east on Third Street to the Xenia pike, and thence along the Xenia pike to their quarries, about two miles further out. The children born of this marriage were William Winters, Valentine Barth, married to Lulu Platt, and Robert Russell.

During the summer of 1851, Mr. and Mrs. Winters dissolved their connection, the one as

trustee, the other as a member, with the German Reformed Congregation of Dayton. On the 6th of the following September, Mrs. Winters was received into the Third Street Presbyterian Church, in Dayton, by letter of dismissal from the Reformed Church, and on the 6th of the following December, Valentine Winters was received into the same church on a profession of his faith in Christ. The Rev. Dr. John W. Hall was then pastor of the Third Street Presbyterian Church.

VII.

IN the spring of 1852. Jonathan Harshman (the eldest son of him whose death we have just chronicled), Valentine Winters, James R. Young, and Robert R. Dickey, formed a co-partnership for the purpose of carrying on a general banking business in the city of Dayton, under the firm name of Harshman, Winters & Company. They opened their doors for business in the room situated on the northeast corner of Main and Third streets, Mr. Winters having previously removed his store two doors north on Main Street, to a room belonging to his wife. They began business under very

favorable auspices, as the Dayton Bank had just sold its charter and was preparing to close up, and they succeeded to a large portion of its business.

On the 8th of July of the following year, Mr. Robert R. Dickey retired from the firm, and on the 15th of the following September, Mr. James R. Young sold his interest in the same to the remaining partners. The firm name was then changed to Harshman & Winters.

Prior to this, however, Jonathan Harshman and Valentine Winters had purchased over four fifths of the capital stock of the Preble County Branch of the State Bank of Ohio, located at Eaton. They were now enabled to make use of it in connection with their banking business in Dayton. As there was not a sufficient demand for money in Eaton and its vicinity for the Preble County Branch Bank to find constant employment for its funds, Harshman and Winters remedied this difficulty by loaning this surplus in Dayton at rates ranging from ten to twelve per cent, and then had the paper rediscounted, they, of course, guaranteeing it, at the Preble County Branch Bank at six per cent, the highest rate that its charter permitted it to take.

On the retirement of Mr. Young, J. H. Gorman

and J. H. Winters were taken into the bank as assistant tellers and messengers. H. C. Hiestand was the teller, and Andrew Hamilton, book-keeper. Soon after this, John M. Grey, the cashier of the Preble County Branch Bank, died, and H. C. Hiestand was appointed to the vacant cashiership. This threw upon the assistant tellers a greater responsibility than they were equal to, considering their limited experience, and the result was a large accumulation of counterfeit money. Mr. Harshman, who was quite a good judge of money, made it his business, as far as his other duties would permit, to examine the currency taken in through the day and select therefrom all of the counterfeit and broken bank bills, and with them in hand "would point a moral and adorn a tale," hoping, in this way, to stimulate the new tellers to greater caution. As they were both apt scholars in this line, these lessons were not lost upon them.

In the spring of 1854 the Exchange Bank (for so Harshman and Winters had named their bank) was quite flush of money. This was caused not so much by a great plethora of it in the county, as it was by the rivalry of neighboring bankers, who, in their anxiety for business, had established the pernicious custom of paying six per cent interest on

daily balances. Thus had been drawn into the various banks of the city nearly all of the floating capital of the surrounding country. As the Exchange Bank had unquestioned credit, great sums of money were placed in its hands, and the list of its depositors was greatly increased, but that other essential to good banking, a corresponding number of responsible borrowers, was lacking. Hence it felt compelled to take its chances in what bankers look upon as questionable loans,—that is, loans whose collaterals have a prospective but no certain value in the money market, and which, if overtaken by a general financial convulsion, are liable to become completely worthless; as, for instance, bonds and stocks of unfinished railroads, etc.

Following this plethora came a corresponding stringency. The fall and winter of that year was a period of great financial prostration. The stock bank bubble, which had been inflated to its utmost capacity by the currency issues of Indiana, Illinois, and other States, now burst and “wild cat,” “red dog,” and other nondescript issues “went to the wall” and carried with them many banking and commercial houses that deserved a better fate. They were caught, however, in the vortex of the maelstrom and had to go. The business horizon

suddenly grew black with clouds and an almost universal loss of confidence was felt.

As a natural consequence there was a manifest uneasiness amongst the customers of Harshman & Winters, followed by a rapid though quiet falling off of deposits. There was no outward or visible excitement, no crowd at any time filled the room or gathered about the door clamoring for their money; but, although a "still run," the drain was heavy, and the surplus funds of the bank were gradually disappearing, with but few new deposits coming in to fill their place. It was here and now, under these discouraging circumstances, that the traits of character were brought out that distinguished Valentine Winters as being cool, capable, and conservative, and not lacking in that grit and daring which every business man finds, at one period of his life or another, so necessary to his success.

Money was being withdrawn from the bank much more rapidly than it was deposited, or could be collected in from their bills receivable, especially when said bills receivable were shrinking daily from heavy and unexpected losses. Added to this a neighboring banker, one who had done more than all others to stimulate the pernicious

custom of paying interest on call deposits, was now realizing the folly of this proceeding in his own business, and, in his distress, called on Harshman & Winters for help. His need was urgent and his call was loud, and, notwithstanding their own pressing necessities, they realized that their inclinations and interests united in demanding a favorable answer to his appeal. So, from time to time, as the exigencies of his business demanded, they made him advances until they amounted, in the aggregate, to about fifty thousand dollars, when the low condition of their own cash reserve called a halt, and when this fountain of supply was stopped, he suspended payment. It is but just to add here that the said advances were, after a considerable lapse of time, repaid with interest.

This failure, of course, multiplied the difficulties of Harshman & Winters, and ordinary men, placed as they were at this juncture, with their cash reserve at its lowest point, and a neighboring banker closing his doors with fifty thousand dollars of their available means in his possession, would have succumbed to the apparently inevitable, and have followed his example. This would have been a disaster to the city, and have entailed privations and misery on hundreds of their fellow-

citizens who had entrusted them with their small savings.

Valentine Winters, however, was not made of that kind of stuff. He believed in keeping open doors as long as there was a dollar in bank to pay with. Always cool and self-possessed, he met his customers when they came to withdraw their deposits, with the air of one who had untold thousands of ready cash at his command, for which he had but little use, and that they would be conferring a favor on him by withdrawing a portion of it, so that some, who came fully determined to draw their money, returned to their homes without it, satisfied that it was safer with Harshman & Winters than it would be in their own possession. It was with them as it was with the old Frenchman, who, under similar circumstances, exclaimed: "You got him, eh? If you got him I no want him, but if you no got him I want him very bad!"

As a rule, men fail to realize that a banker having considerable deposits on which he pays interest, cannot afford to keep any large portion of them on hand unemployed, and, as a consequence, he finds it difficult to be always prepared for the sudden financial panics which, at intervals, overspread our country. It is also found to be extremely diffi-

cult to establish and maintain such a percentage between the cash reserves and liabilities as shall insure perfect safety in the operations of the bank. The national bank law of to-day calls for a cash reserve of twenty-five per cent in the large cities, and for fifteen only in the smaller cities and towns; but the general suspension of all the banks in the large cities, and many of them in the smaller towns during the Jay Cooke panic, shows how utterly inadequate this percentage proves to be in a period of widespread prostration and alarm. A banker must depend upon his own resources, and not on the expectation of outside help in case of trouble, for, in a time of a general loss of confidence, those upon whom he could ordinarily lean, are themselves in the same straits, and, consequently, can afford no help. Where, then, is this outside help to come from? The defect lies in the custom of paying interest on that which good banking forbids the most advantageous use of.

Bankers of to-day do not experience the same difficulties which banks and bankers experienced thirty years ago. Now they can loan on call with government bonds or first-class dividend paying shares as collateral, for these can be converted, with but little sacrifice, in the most stringent

panics. At that time, however, there were no government bonds to be had, and first-class dividend paying shares were scarce, and, as a rule, not held by borrowers, and loans were almost invariably made for a period of time on personal endorsement. Many of their borrowers were in such distress themselves that it was difficult for them to pay the interest on the renewals of their paper, and were only able to pay the principal long after the subsidence of the panic. Experience proves that accommodation paper is a poor reliance in a time of financial upheaval.

Tiding his business over that monetary crisis was the occasion of many anxious days and weary nights to Valentine Winters, but, with a hand steadily on the helm and a watchful eye seeking to penetrate the murkiness of the surrounding financial atmosphere, he steered his gallant bark into a safe and quiet haven. But, O, how many were the wrecks that had been scattered along the shore, and how sad the condition of the bills receivable of the Exchange Bank when the partners undertook the melancholy task of separating the wheat from the chaff.

It is a matter of fact that, when two years later, Jonathan Harshman retired from the firm,

although the net profits of the bank for five years appeared to be over one hundred thousand dollars, the cash divided between the partners was but little over eleven hundred dollars; the remainder consisted, in bankers' parlance, of "chips and whetstones," on which but little was ever afterward realized.

This cannot be considered a brilliant example of successful banking, if we measure it by the standard of profits, but in view of the fact that the Exchange Bank maintained its credit through a great financial convulsion, against great odds, and became firmly rooted in the confidence of the people, thus paving the way for the success of the firm succeeding it, may it not be looked upon in the nature of a drawn battle with the chances in favor of the bank? or its career likened to the skirmish line, which "feels" the enemy and finds and points out the way for the advance of the victorious columns of the main army?



VIII.

WE are again called upon to record one of those oft-recurring social events which create such commotion in the household, and while they are on the whole joyful, still there is an element of sorrow entering into each one, arising from the fact that, in the formation of these new ties many old ones are more or less severed. On the 12th of November, 1856, Mary Eliza, the third daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, was united in the holy bonds of matrimony with Dr. Clarke McDermont, and they were thenceforward "no longer twain but one." The ceremony was performed by the Rev. David Winters, and its celebration was a quiet one, as only a few of the immediate relatives of the bride were in attendance. It occurred in the early morning, and immediately after the wedding breakfast the happy pair took the train for Louisville. How enjoyable these little episodes are, occurring as they do in the midst of the cares and trials of life. How they lift our thoughts above such things and develop the romance which dwells, to a greater or less degree, in each of our hearts. We linger over them as over a sweet

morsel, and memory recalls them with an undying interest.

The only issue of this marriage was a son, Horace, who, in due course of time, married Rosalie Thruston, of Cumberland, Maryland.

On the 9th of February, 1857, Jonathan Harshman sold his interest in the firm of Harshman & Winters to his partner. The strain had been heavy upon him and he became discouraged, and wished to retire permanently from the business, hence the sale. Mr. Winters then associated with him his son, Jonathan H., gave him a one-third interest, and they continued the banking business under the firm name of V. Winters & Son. There was no capital stock paid in and no large surplus fund provided; the new firm banked purely and simply on their individual credit. The old firm had turned over to them in cash, bills receivable, stocks, bonds, and real estate a sufficient amount in value to cover all of their outstanding obligations, these having been assumed by the new firm. In lieu of capital paid in, the individual assets of the partners were liable for all of the debts of the bank. The retirement of Mr. Harshman seemed to have no injurious effect on the business of the bank and everything moved on much as usual.

On the 9th of the following June, Jonathan H., the eldest son of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, took to himself a wife in the person of Susan Louella, the eldest daughter of Richard (then deceased) and Nancy Bates, of Cincinnati, Ohio. Richard Bates was a native of Holbeach, England, (the place where the conspirators of the "gunpowder plot" made their last stand, and by the by there was one Thomas Bates amongst them); was born August 6, 1809, and died March 21, 1856, while his wife, Nancy, was born near Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, March 4, 1814. The wedding was celebrated at the residence of the bride's mother, in Cincinnati, and the ceremony was performed by the Rev. G. D. Archibald, of the Associate Reformed Church, of which both the bride and her mother were members. It was a morning wedding with no attendants, and only a few of the near relatives and immediate friends of the bride and groom present, but it was none the less enjoyable for all that. The children born of this marriage were Louella, Clara, and Valentine.

The newly-married couple took an extended wedding journey through Canada and the East. Whilst in New York, the groom took occasion to withdraw from the custody of the Ohio Life In-

insurance and Trust Company, where they had been left on special deposit by his firm, about one hundred and fifty thousand dollars of the bonds of the Dayton and Western Railroad Company. From the actions of the cashier of said company and from the delay to which the junior was subjected in getting possession of said bonds, he was led to believe that the "Trust Company" had borrowed money on them, and now experienced considerable difficulty in arranging to take them up. The junior, however, staid by him till he got them and, after withdrawing another lot of bonds from Atwood & Co., secured them all in a package and sent them home by express. The importance, to the new firm, of getting possession of these bonds at this juncture will manifest itself further on.

During the latter part of the following August, the commercial world was again stirred to its very foundations by a panic in the money market, followed by a general and heavy break down of prices and the suspension of specie payments by nearly every bank in the United States. It was brought about partly by an excessive importation of foreign goods and partly by a too-rapid construction of railways with borrowed capital. A partial failure of crops lessened the ability of the country to pay

for its imported goods, hence coin was largely exported, and the conservative element of Wall Street became anxious to escape the pending danger and fearful of its results. The failure of the Ohio Life Insurance and Trust Company was the starting point of the panic. It was an Ohio company, having a branch office in New York, and had a high credit, but it was wrecked by the speculations of its New York agent, and its collapse was like placing a lighted match in a powder magazine, so disastrous was its effects on other similar institutions and on values throughout the country.

V. Winters & Son kept their New York balances with the Ohio Life Insurance and Trust Company, Beebe & Co., and Atwood & Co., and regarded them each as being safe beyond question. Their confidence was, however, rudely shaken one sultry August day by the receipt of a telegram from Atwood & Co., announcing the failure of the Ohio Life Insurance and Trust Company. The New York remittances of the following day were then sent to Atwood & Co. In a day or two a telegram came from Beebe & Co., containing the intelligence of the failure of Atwood & Co. The effect of this telegram was electrical, but as Beebe & Co. claimed to be specie brokers and had the reputation of

being towers of strength in the financial world, confidence in them remained unbroken, and that day's remittances were sent to them. The next day Jonathan Harshman, who was then in New York, telegraphed the appalling announcement that Beebe & Co. had failed.

To Valentine Winters and his youthful partner, it appeared as if the end of all things, financially, was approaching. Every move that they had made after the failure of the Trust Company had been a blunder, and now, who should they trust and what would the end be? The outlook was very dark. Fortunately for them, however, Jonathan Harshman had just sold a large consignment of flour for the firm of Harshman & Brothers, and the proceeds were still in the hands of his commission merchant, Isaac H. Reed. Him he directed to pay all the outstanding drafts of V. Winters & Son on the defunct bank and bankers.

These failures were all believed to be bad ones, but the senior partner took them in hand, and through his tact and good management collected the bank's claim in full from the Ohio Life Insurance and Trust Company, two thirds of that of Beebe & Company, and about one half of that of Atwood & Company. These losses made the

first year's business of the new firm unprofitable, but it taught them to exercise greater caution and added largely to their experience.

We are again called upon to attend one of those festive gatherings, which, though of frequent occurrence in the family of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, were none the less welcomed, and each succeeding one seemed to exceed its predecessor in the interest which it aroused. In this instance it was Catharine, the fourth daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, who, on the 15th of November, 1860, was joined in the holy bonds of wedlock with Lewis B. Gunckel. The officiating clergyman was the Rev. David Winters, and the attendants were Milton Saylor, O. A. Lyman, Victoria H. Clegg, and Helen McGregor. A large concourse of relatives and friends participated in the festivities.

Mr. Gunckel was a native of Germantown, and of course, more or less of an "Isaac Walton" and a "Nimrod," a graduate of Farmers' College, and at this time a member of the prosperous legal firm of Gunckel & Strong. The children of this marriage were Winters, Katharine, Lewis, and Percy, of whom Winters and Percy did not survive their childhood.

IX.

DURING the following April, 1861, the War of the Great Rebellion broke out, by which this country was convulsed politically and financially to its very foundations. For a time business was paralyzed. Before the attack on Fort Sumter the Southern merchants had virtually repudiated all debts due to Northern creditors, but the echoes of the first gun fired there sounded the death knell to any hopes that might have been entertained as to a future satisfactory adjustment of their claims. Fortunately our city had little, if any, business connection with the South, hence escaped any direct loss by reason of this wholesale repudiation.

Valentine Winters was eminently patriotic, and from the bombardment of Fort Sumter to the closing scene at the Appomattox his faith in the final success of the Union armies was clear and strong. At a meeting of the Board of Control of the State Bank of Ohio, which held its annual meeting at Columbus during the following May, and of which he was a member (he represented the Preble County Branch of the State Bank of Ohio,

of which he was also president), he was one of the first to advocate that it was the duty, as it also should be the policy of the Ohio banks, to supply the exhausted treasury of the State with means to facilitate the equipment of soldiers for the army, and as there was no law to meet the case, to rely on the honor and patriotism of the State for their reimbursement. To this end he pledged the bank he represented for its *pro rata* share. Later on his firm was the first in the city of Dayton to subscribe for the then new and untried, but afterward popular 5-20 loan. The first sale of this class of bonds, made over the counter of the Exchange Bank, was ten thousand dollars to F. Gebhart & Son, of Dayton, Ohio.

Mr. Winters was always more or less of a politician, not in the sense of being a seeker after office; he did not want, nor would he accept any political preferment, but in this, that he loved his country and was always ready to help with purse or personal service anything that, in his estimation, would contribute to her highest good. Originally a Jackson Democrat, the removal of the deposits from the United States Bank switched him into the opposition, and when the Whig party was split in twain by slavery, his love of justice and right con-

ducted him into the Republican camp. With him it was his country first, foremost, and all the time. There was no enterprise on foot in this city, either for the raising of soldiers by special bounty enlistment, or for the relief of their families and afterwards of their widows, in which Valentine Winters was not considered a factor, and no deserving calls were made upon him which he did not answer willingly, cheerfully, and promptly.

His greatest gifts, however, on the altar of patriotism, were his two sons, George and Reuben, who enlisted at different intervals, the first named in the Ninety-third Ohio, and the other in the Second Ohio Heavy Artillery, and, though his heart must have bled when he saw his own flesh and blood buckling on the accouterments of war, no Spartan mother ever sent forth her sons to battle and concealed the anguish that was lacerating her heart strings better than did he.

We have before us a commission, dated October 16, 1862, issued to Valentine Winters as second lieutenant of the Eighth Regiment, Ohio Volunteer Cavalry, and signed by Charles W. Hill, adjutant-general of the State of Ohio. This was granted to him for furnishing, at his own expense, twenty recruits for the army, and was, at his

request, transferred to his son George, then home on a sick furlough.

Whilst in New York in the early summer of 1861, Valentine Winters and E. F. Drake, in behalf of Jonathan Harshman, J. H. Winters, and themselves, entered into a contract with the Minnesota & Pacific Railroad Company, by which they engaged to construct and equip the first ten miles of said railroad, it being that portion lying between and connecting the cities of St. Paul and Minneapolis, Minnesota. By legislative enactment it had been stipulated that the said ten miles should be built prior to January 1, 1862, and as a guaranty of good faith, that, before beginning work on the same, the railroad company should deposit with the State officials the sum of ten thousand dollars, which sum, together with the land grant, charter, and franchise, should be forfeited to the State unless said conditions were complied with.

Under their contract with the railroad company, Messrs. Winters, Harshman & Drake were to make this deposit for the railroad company, and, on the completion of their contract, were to receive, first, the return of the ten thousand dollars pledged with the State officials; second, one hundred and twenty thousand dollars eight per cent bonds,

whose payment should be secured by a first mortgage on said ten miles of railroad and its equipment, and, third, one hundred and twenty sections of land to be selected by them out of the "land grant" of the railroad company lying in Wright, Hennepin, and Carver counties, Minnesota. V. and J. H. Winters assumed four sixths of the above contract, and Jonathan Harshman and E. F. Drake each one sixth.

As the time granted them for the completion of their contract was short, they set immediately to work and purchased the iron, locomotives, cars, and other equipments and forwarded them to St. Paul. They also made the required deposit with the State officials, and had the work well in hand and progressing, when they were suddenly brought to a halt by an injunction suit having reference to the right of way. Things now looked squally for these embryo contractors. The railroad officials had deceived them about the right of way, as much of it was found to be still in controversy, and they ascertained that, even if they got rid of this suit, others would follow, so, acting under the advice of Governor Ramsey and other friends, they concluded to cease work, store their supplies, submit to the forfeiture, and, at the next session of the

legislature, throw themselves upon its mercy. This was a wise thing for them to do, as there was no railroad in all Minnesota, although many had been projected, and their people had been so frequently deceived by these mushroom growths that now to see the iron cars, and locomotives actually in St. Paul and waiting to be made use of, made them clamorous for the completion of this road and impatient of the obstacles that were thrown in its way. Messrs. Winters and Drake then returned to their homes with depressed spirits, and would have sold their prospective profits for a song had any buyer been in the market.

The following winter was unusually severe, but, unmindful of this, Messrs. Winters and Drake, shortly prior to the meeting of the Minnesota legislature, took their departure for St. Paul. They journeyed by rail to La Crosse and then by sledges to St. Paul, passing over Lake Pepin on the ice.

In the meantime the State of Minnesota had foreclosed the mortgage they held on the Minnesota & Pacific Railroad and bought it in, together with the franchise, and had thus extinguished all claims against the road bed, and placed the legis-

lature in position to grant a new and more favorable charter on the same line of road. The people of St. Paul and Minneapolis, now that a railroad was in sight, determined not to lose it, and brought such a pressure to bear upon the legislature (not a money pressure, for not one dollar was spent by Messrs. Winters and Drake, or in their interests, to obtain needed legislation) that that body was unusually gracious to Messrs. Winters and Drake on their arrival in St. Paul and granted them all the legislation they asked for.

A new corporation, called the St. Paul & Pacific Railroad Company, was formed, and to it was granted all the rights and privileges of the old company. The time for the forfeiture of the ten thousand dollars then in the hands of the State authorities was extended to July 1, 1862, as was also the completion of the first ten miles of said road. After making a contract with the St. Paul and Pacific Railroad Company, which was essentially the same as that previously had with the Minnesota & Pacific Railroad Company, Messrs. Winters & Drake started on their homeward journey with a lifted burden.

They descended the Mississippi River in a sleigh and were only partially protected from the cutting

winds and intense cold by a canvas cover, under which they took shelter. During the night the sleigh ran into, and was suddenly stopped by, a great fissure in the ice, to the confusion and dismay of the occupants. One called out that he was in the water. With this alarming intelligence to spur them on it did not take the other passengers long to produce their pocket-knives and cut their way out from under the heavy canvas cover. The cry of water proved to be a false one, and as no one was hurt and the sleigh uninjured, they continued their journey rejoicing and reached home without further mishap.

On the first of September, 1861, the banking office of V. Winters & Son was removed from the northeast corner of Third and Main streets, one door north on Main Street, to the room still occupied by their successor, the Winters National Bank. At this time Andrew Hamilton had charge of the individual ledger; Leonard Moore, the general ledger and correspondence, and George H. Winters was teller. When the spring of 1862 had fully opened in Minnesota, Valentine Winters and E. F. Drake, joined later by Jonathan Harshman, went to St. Paul, where they secured a large working force and proceeded vigorously to com-

plete their contract. By the first of July the road was finished and in running order, and the first free railroad excursion in Minnesota inaugurated. They then returned to their homes, taking with them the products of their labors. To the handsome profit which these yielded they had the added honor of having built and equipped the first railroad in Minnesota.

X.

In the spring of 1862, at administrator's sale of the effects of Daniel Beckel, the charter and franchise of the Dayton Bank were purchased by Jonathan H. Gorman, and by him resold, one half to V. Winters & Son and the other half to Harshman & Gorman. The capital stock was made good and a re-organization effected by electing Valentine Winters, president, and R. D. Harshman, cashier. The next year V. Winters & Son sold their interest in said bank to Harshman & Gorman, when R. D. Harshman became president, and Andrew Hamilton, cashier.

In the midsummer of 1863 the peace of mind of the Dayton bankers was slightly disturbed by the raid of John Morgan and his rebel horde through

the southern portions of Indiana and Ohio. His course was so eccentric that no one within a radius of fifty miles of it felt safe from a visit. So the bankers of Dayton got their heads together and agreed "that he who fights and runs away lives to fight another day," but that prudence would dictate that they should avoid even the first engagement. In view of this, they packed up their valuables, placed them in a freight car and forwarded them to Toledo in charge of a guard of honor, consisting of one or more members from each bank. The Preble County Branch of the State Bank of Ohio, at Eaton, was represented by H. C. Hiestand; V. Winters & Son, by Leonard Moore; the Dayton Branch of the State Bank of Ohio, by John H. Achey and B. G. G. Young; the First National Bank of Dayton, by G. B. Harman; the Second National Bank of Dayton, by David C. Rensch, and Harshman & Gorman, by R. D. Harshman. The party remained in Toledo till all danger from Morgan had passed and then returned with their valuables to Dayton. They do not seem to have belonged to that class of bankers who long for the quietude of Canada, else, being so near, a short ride would have landed them safe with their booty in that much-favored land.

Again we pause in our narrative to listen to the sound of the wedding bells. What is there, in all this wide world, that creates so great an excitement in a family and neighborhood as a wedding? This time the high contracting parties were Laura, one of the twin daughters of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, and Robert McGregor, of Cincinnati. The wedding occurred on the 17th of September, 1863, at the residence of the bride's parents in Dayton, and was largely attended by relatives and friends. The ceremony was performed by the Rev. S. G. Spees, pastor of the Third Street Presbyterian Church, and the attendants were Joseph Emery, William McAlpin, James McGregor, Lizzie Riddle, Mary Barney, and Clara Winters, twin sister to the bride. Robert McGregor had been a soldier in the Union army. He was commissioned as first lieutenant of the Thirteenth Missouri Infantry, and had participated in the bloody engagements of Fort Donaldson and Shiloh. At the time of his marriage, however, he had retired from the army, and was engaged in the grocery and commission business in Memphis, Tennessee. The children of this marriage were Robert W., and Charles.

On the second of the following month, the death of the patriarch of the family, the Rev. Thomas

Winters, occurred, as has been previously announced. Births, marriages, and deaths, in what rapid succession they follow each other, and how soon the robes of rejoicing give place to the garments of mourning.

In the summer of 1864, as the charter of the State Bank of Ohio was about to expire, it became necessary to take steps to ensure a continuance of the business of the Preble County Branch Bank at Eaton. On consultation it was determined to reorganize the said bank under the National Bank system. Accordingly, the following persons, Valentine Winters, Jonathan H. Winters, David Barnet, Henry C. Hiestand, and Joseph A. DuSang met in Eaton and subscribed the articles of incorporation of the First National Bank of Eaton. The capital stock, \$100,000, was all taken by the five incorporators. The following were the officers elected to carry on the business of the bank: Valentine Winters, president; Jonathan H. Winters, vice-president; H. C. Hiestand, cashier; and J. A. DuSang, teller. The incorporators were also made directors.

The president was duly authorized to buy the requisite amount (\$100,000) of United States bonds, and take them, with the papers, to Wash-

ington. Having purchased the bonds, Mr. Winters, accompanied by his wife, started off on the journey. The bonds were of the ten-forty-five per cent issue, each for one thousand dollars, and were consequently quite bulky. For greater safety, Mrs. Winters carried them sewed up in her skirts. Unfortunately, they reached Baltimore at that unhappy juncture following General Lew Wallace's check at Monocacy, and found themselves cut off from Washington by Harry Gilmour's rebel band. Not knowing how long this state of siege might last, after a brief visit with their son George, (who was then in Baltimore with Ohio's one hundred days' men,) they continued their journey to New York. As their train was crossing Gunpowder River it was fired upon by the rebels, one bullet passing transversely through the car in which they were seated. Though all the passengers were badly frightened, no one was hurt. As war's alarms kept up, Mr. Winters was compelled to return to his home without having accomplished his purpose.

During the following September, however, as Washington was comparatively safe, and things had grown more "quiet on the Potomac," Mr. J. H. Winters "shouldered" the "ten-forties" and,

accompanied by Henry S. Gunckel, of German-town, proceeded to Washington, filed the papers, and secured the charter for the First National Bank of Eaton.

Two years later there was an unusual bustle in the Winters homestead, and the air was burdened with the fragrance of orange blossoms. This time it was Alice, the seventh daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, who was led to the hymeneal altar by Edwin C. Shaw, of Toledo, Ohio. This event occurred on the 31st of October, 1866. The Rev. R. A. Sawyer, the pastor of the Third Street Presbyterian Church, was the officiating minister, and the attendants were E. S. Forgy, of Dayton; Will Dicks, of Maumee; and Messrs. Tweedy and Potter, of Toledo, and Susan H. Beckel, Martha Perrine, Susan Harshman, and Julia Davies, all of Dayton. The wedding was largely attended, and the ceremonies were impressive. The groom was a native of Madison, Indiana, and had been engaged in business in Dayton for some years, but was, at the period of his marriage, conducting a wholesale notion store in Toledo, where his good looks and gracious manners secured him many customers. The children of this marriage were Edwin, Katharine, George, Carleton, Winters, and

Frederick, of whom the first named and last two have deceased.

Again our ears detect the tinkle, tinkle, tinkle of the wedding bells ushering in, without noise and undue excitement, the marriage of the last daughter remaining under the paternal roof. The bride was Clara, the sixth daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, and one of the twin sisters; the groom was Colonel Lucien B. Eaton, of Memphis, Tennessee. It was on the 26th of December, 1867, when these two were united in marriage by the Rev. Rollin A. Sawyer. Colonel Eaton was a native of New Hampshire, a graduate of Dartmouth College, a colonel in the Union army, and, at this time conducted a daily paper in Memphis called the *Memphis Post*. The children of this marriage were Valentine, Catharine, and Lucien, of whom only Valentine survives.

We have now duly witnessed the wedding ceremonies and the settling in life of each of the children of Valentine and Catharine Winters (except the two younger sons, George H. and Reuben D., who seemed to have successfully withstood the blandishments of the other sex), and grandchildren have gathered about them in a multitudinous array. Their lives move calmly and placidly on with only

here a little and there a little to ruffle the surface. Later a cloud begins to overshadow them which grows in darkness and intensity, and finally culminates in the death of their beloved son, George. He died, in the full prime and vigor of his young manhood, on the 7th of April, 1869, and was buried in Woodland Cemetery. The funeral services were conducted by the Rev. R. A. Sawyer.

At an early period of the War of the Great Rebellion, George had enlisted as a private in Captain S. B. Smith's company, Ninety-third Regiment, Ohio Volunteer Infantry. Before the battle of Richmond, in Kentucky, he was for a time detailed to act as orderly to General Nelson, but, disliking this position, asked and obtained permission to return to the ranks. He was with his regiment when this battle was fought, and retreated with it to Louisville. Here he became quite ill and was sent home on sick furlough. While at home, through the efforts of his father, he obtained a commission as second lieutenant in the Eighth Ohio Volunteer Cavalry. As this regiment failed to recruit its full quota of men, it was consolidated with another skeleton regiment, so that, there now being an excess of officers, George and others were left out. Afterwards when Presi-

dent Lincoln called out the one hundred days' men to protect Baltimore and Washington, George responded to the call, went with Colonel John G. Lowe's regiment to Baltimore and remained with it until mustered out.

Following this, for a lengthened period, there was neither marrying, nor giving in marriage, nor deaths in the family of Valentine and Catharine Winters. They were themselves blessed with health and took a proper pride in their children's prosperity, and enjoyed the sight of their grand-children growing up about them to manhood and womanhood. Their country, which they both loved so well, was at peace with all the world, the land smiled with the abundance of its crops, the banking business was prosperous beyond previous years, and, to crown all, this happy couple were still equal, in bodily health and strength, to the duties of an active, vigorous life. Care and anxiety, if they had any, seemed to sit lightly upon them; they enjoyed their lengthened drives through the country, the pure air of which was at once an elixir and a tonic, and being thus daily refreshed in body and mind, they did not seem to grow old. In May and September of each year it now became the custom of Mr. Winters, in com-

pany with other choice spirits given to angling, to visit Pelee Island, there to make an onslaught on the famous black bass of Lake Erie, and here in the excitement of the chase, age was forgotten and he became a boy again, the first to take boat for the fishing grounds in the morning and the last to pull into port at night, unmindful of sun, or wind, or storm. He seemed to know no fear, was never sea sick, and took chances in the pursuit of bass which made old fishermen shudder, and so, when he came home with blistered face and hands, and, whilst applying cooling lotions, how his eyes would sparkle as he told us of the small bass he had caught and of the big ones that had gotten away.

XI.

In the meanwhile his interest in the banking house, of which he was the head, did not flag, and, although he had long since surrendered the general management and oversight of its business to his partner, he still kept himself thoroughly posted in its details, so as to be ready for any emergency that might call him to its active management. During these years and until the fall of 1873, the current of business was singularly smooth

and fairly prosperous. Then, in the month of September, came another of those financial panics, so prevalent in this country, and which sweep over it with such cyclonic force. It was precipitated, not caused, by the failure of Jay Cooke & Company. The cause lies further back and deeper. Enormous importations and over-trade, coupled with a too rapid extension of the railroad system of the country, brought about such a state of affairs that Jay Cooke & Company's failure was but a match applied to a train of combustibles, and the result was immediate and complete. A sudden and seemingly irresistible loss of confidence took possession of New York and spread like wildfire over the whole country. Every man was afraid of his neighbor, and, as a natural result of such a state of affairs, the banks in all the leading cities of the country suspended payment, and thereby occasioned almost unparalleled confusion. Throughout the country there were many failures of banks and bankers, and two notable ones of the latter class, occurred in Dayton.

These failures, however, had no injurious effect on the banking business of V. Winters & Son, but only served to strengthen them more and more with the public. They had accumulated a large

surplus, and had kept it legitimately employed in their business, so that when "the winds blew and the floods" of financial distrust beat upon them they were not only prepared to stem the current but were also able to assist others to tide over the crisis. Be it said to the credit of the Dayton banks and bankers, other than those already mentioned as having failed, that they did not, through the whole period of this extraordinary crisis, suspend payment, as did the banks in Cincinnati and all the large cities, but promptly paid every legitimate demand. This is a splendid record for them, considering the bank failures here, and the large portion of their cash reserves which was locked up with their Cincinnati and New York correspondents.

We now record with sorrow the death of Jonathan Harshman, the old-time partner of Valentine Winters. This sad event occurred on Christmas Day, 1876. Mr. Harshman was a man of broad views and generous impulses, a tender and loving husband and father, and a kind friend, and his sudden death was a severe blow to an extensive circle of relatives and friends. He was a man of sterling integrity, and was usually successful in his business ventures until, at an evil moment, he fell

into the hands of Wall Street brokers, and was ultimately plucked of his hard earned possessions. The suspension of his firm, following after the Jay Cooke & Co. panic, was such a blow to him and weighed so heavily upon him that it was probably the ultimate cause of his death.

On the 22d of January, 1877, Robert McGregor, the husband of Laura, the fifth daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, died suddenly in Baltimore, Maryland, leaving a widow and two children to mourn his loss. His remains were brought to Dayton and buried in Woodland Cemetery.

We are now approaching an event which is of rare occurrence in the history of families, and one which is not soon forgotten by those who were fortunate enough to participate in its enjoyment. We will let the correspondent of the *Dayton Journal* tell the story in his fascinating and inimitable manner:

GOLDEN WEDDING.

The Fiftieth Marriage Anniversary of Mr. and Mrs. Valentine Winters Celebrated by their Children and Grandchildren.

On the 1st of January, 1829, Valentine Winters and Catharine Harshman were married at the residence of the bride's father, in Harshmanville. The

happy couple have resided in Dayton ever since their union. Yesterday completed their fiftieth year of matrimonial life, and found them at their old and pleasant homestead on Third Street, enjoying apparently as much mental and bodily vigor as when their destinies were first united. The union of Mr. and Mrs. Winters has been signally blessed in its results. They have nine children and twenty-three grandchildren now living. We understand it was the intention of the subjects of this notice to celebrate their golden wedding in a manner worthy of the occasion, and of the high social position of the family, but the serious illness of Mr. Reuben Winters, their youngest son, caused the abandonment of this purpose. Last week, however, there was a favorable change in the condition of the invalid, and the other members of the family taking advantage of this improvement, determined that the eventful day should not pass without at least a private celebration. Consent was reluctantly given, and very soon the daughters were organized into committees, and the work of preparation for the golden ceremonies was entered upon. The joyful energy with which each one addressed herself to the task insured a timely and successful completion of the work in hand. Mrs. Dickey, Mrs.

McGregor, and Mrs. Shaw looked after the table comforts. Mrs. Gunckel and Mrs. J. H. Winters supervised the floral decorations, while to Mrs. Darst and Mrs. McDermont was assigned the large department of miscellaneous affairs. Mr. and Mrs. Winters were exempted from all duty and responsibility, and remarked that it was the first time they had ever been superseded in the control of their own house. For reasons already stated, the invitations were restricted to the children and grandchildren. At 5 o'clock p. m., the large family group had assembled in Mr. Winters' drawing-room, where the bride and groom of half a century received the warmest congratulations and other more substantial tokens of affectionate regard. The following persons were present: Mr. and Mrs. N. B. Darst, with two daughters and five sons; Mr. R. R. Dickey and wife, and two sons; Dr. and Mrs. C. McDermont, and son; J. H. Winters, wife, two daughters and son; Mr. L. B. Gunckel, wife, son and daughter; Mrs. McGregor and two sons; Mr. Edwin C. Shaw, wife, two sons and daughter. Col. and Mrs. L. B. Eaton, of Memphis, were unable to be present. Mr. Charles W. Darst and his bride were most conspicuous in the happy group of grandchildren.

An hour or more was spent in the interchange of friendly salutations and examining the exquisite handiwork of the ladies, who had robbed the season of its natural gloom by a profuse array of fresh evergreen and brilliant flowers, distributed throughout the house in the highest style of decorative art. While thus engaged a signal was given for the company to come to order, whereupon Mr. J. H. Winters advanced in front of the bride and groom and addressed them as follows:

DEAR FATHER AND MOTHER:—With overflowing hearts we have gathered our children about us, and come to greet you on this your fiftieth anniversary. That precious book which should be prized above all others, and to whose teachings we may ascribe the blessings we enjoy, utters with a pointed significance the true intent of our meeting here to-day. The words are the golden ones, "Honor thy father and thy mother," and with this in view, and without losing sight of the blessings attached to the command, we have gathered about you at this time, not only to do you honor, but in some faint measure to express in words and actions the love we bear you. We rejoice that your lives have been spared to us so long; that time has dealt so gently with you, and that we can gather about you, children and grandchildren, in the old homestead, while you are yet in the full enjoyment of health and all your faculties, almost an unbroken family. Words at such a time are inadequate to express the feelings that well up

within us, while memory carries us back through the intervening years to the days of our childhood, when you were the source and the inspiration of all our joys; when we played about your knees without a care or thought that went beyond the passing moments, blessed with health, and, through the fruit of your labors, surrounded with comforts, a happy family, a united family.

Thus our years went by until the swaddling-bands of youth were thrown off, roundabouts and short dresses were abandoned, and the children of yesterday became the men and women of to-day.

Then came the partings. One by one, in almost regular succession, new ties were formed, and the home circle decreased as one by one its members left the old homestead to take up the new duties and to battle with life's difficulties. From them new families sprung, and to-day nine children and twenty-three grandchildren rise up to call you blessed. But alas! we cannot gather around you even now an altogether unbroken family. One of our number, though with us in sympathy and affection, and to whose annual visits we look forward with exceeding pleasure, cannot be with us to-day to join us in our congratulations, but we all know no heart beats with more loyal and unselfish affection than hers, and that no one would be more willing to contribute to the general rejoicing of the day, and take more pleasure in it, than our sister Clara.

At long intervals we have been called to mingle our tears over two of our number. One brother known only to his elder sisters, was taken in the early springtime of life, before the bud had unfolded its petals, but his mem-

ory has ever been freshly cherished in our hearts; and the other, with his splendid physique, his large, warm heart, his many endearing ways, was cut down in the full prime and vigor of manhood, and there remain to us a string of tender memories encircling the name of George.

One dear sister mourns the loss of a husband, and others have wept and sorrowed over their children, dear, precious jewels, who were lent them for a little season, and were then taken to that brighter home in the Father's house to be forever sheltered by infinite love. While dropping a tear over the graves of our dear departed ones, we leave them in the hands of a merciful Father, who doeth all things well, and we rejoice in the goodness and mercy which have followed you all the days of your life, and which we trust may go with you to the end. As a slight testimonial of our affection, I take pleasure in presenting you, in behalf of your whole family, with this little memento, and to express the hope that its bright golden surface may be but the reflection of the remaining years of your life. That God may bless you both, is the united prayer of your children and your children's children.

Here the marriage plate was presented, and is described as follows: It is a golden plate, two sizes larger than the largest dinner plate. Occupying one-half the outer rim in high relief, in Old English, is the command, "Honor thy father and thy mother." The other half contains, in German text, the following: "Winters - 1829 - 1879 - Harshman." In the center of the plate is beautifully engraved

a group of figures representing the marriage sacrament. Above this is the messenger of glad tidings flying through the air, blowing two trumpets. Below is the wedding ring, gracefully entwined in a spray of honeysuckle, emblems of conjugal love. It is handsomely mounted in a blue velvet case, and is the work of Tiffany & Co., New York, from an original design. On the reverse side of the plate are the names of the children, as follows: Susannah H. Darst, Martha Jane Dickey, Mary Eliza McDermont, Jonathan H. Winters, Charles H. Winters, Kate W. Gunckel, Clara W. Eaton, Laura W. McGregor, George H. Winters, Reuben D. Winters, Alice W. Shaw.

Mr. Winters and his wife were deeply affected by this speech and the presentation of the plate, which was wholly unexpected. In response he could only express his overwhelming sense of joy at this new proof of his children's devotion. Supper was then announced, and the whole company sat down to a sumptuous banquet, and did full justice to the *menu*, which we will not attempt to describe. Toasts and speeches followed and the remainder of the evening was enlivened with a pleasing variety of instrumental and vocal music. The songs of other days and the old

favorite songs of the family were recalled and applauded. Many kindred voices joined in the chorus, and all went "merry as a marriage bell." Miss Louella Winters, by request, varied the entertainment by reading, in her best style, Longfellow's poem, "The Hanging of the Crane;" and Master Georgie Shaw's rendition of the "Young Turk" met with a flattering encore. His voice was not exactly modulated to the capacity of the large drawing-room, but this slight defect was amply compensated by the unique style of his dramatic delivery. Among the grandchildren were several young collegians, whose spirited club songs elicited a full share of the evening's applause.

All golden weddings are interesting on account of their rarity, but this of Mr. Winters and his wife possesses some extraordinary features which entitle it to a special celebration. One remarkable feature is the almost uninterrupted good health of the parties. Both have attained the age of three score and ten without any visible or conscious sign that they are nearing the limit allotted to human life. As was stated by one of the speakers last evening, Mr. Winters is not only the youngest looking man of his years in Dayton, but the best

looking gentleman in Ohio. Another extraordinary feature in the life of this couple is their uninterrupted prosperity. Mr. Winters commenced life as a boy working in a brick-yard, near Germantown, at ten cents per day. He then went into a store in Dayton and commenced clerking at fifty dollars per year, and rose year after year, as already shown by his cash book, first to a partner in the store, then sole proprietor, and finally a banker, in which capacity he is best known to the present generation.

As a banker he has conducted his business with the same energy, caution, and probity that insured success in his previous mercantile operations. He has confined himself strictly to legitimate banking, resisting the temptation to embark on the glittering sea of speculation which has lured so many others to shipwreck and ruin. During the many financial panics that have passed over the country in the past thirty years, the banking house of which Mr. Winters is the head has never suffered in public confidence. The storms of financial distress descended, and the floods came and beat upon that house, and it fell not, because it was founded on a rock.

Another feature that will be generally recognized

is the liberality and generosity of both Mr. and Mrs. Winters in all public, religious, and charitable enterprises, refusing no applications, but generously responding to all.

Still another interesting feature of the wedded life of Mr. and Mrs. Winters is their success in raising a large family and so training them that their affectionate devotion to each other and to their parents is really a family trait so strongly marked as to be universally recognized in the community by all who are acquainted with them. As was remarked by one of the speakers last evening, this extraordinary loyalty is due, in a great measure, to the uniform kindness and absolute impartiality of the parents in all their intercourse with their children.

Our space will not permit a report of the speeches, or further detail of the proceedings of the evening, which were closed by the whole company joining in singing "Home, Sweet Home," followed by the doxology.



XII.

On the 24th of the following May (1879), the participants of the late "golden wedding" were saddened by the death of Reuben, the youngest son of Mr. and Mrs. Winters. During the early stages of the late war, Reuben had joined the "Squirrel Hunters," and went with them to Cincinnati to assist in protecting it from Kirby Smith's raid. Later he enlisted in the Second Regiment, Ohio Heavy Artillery, and served with it until mustered out at the close of the Rebellion. He saw active service during nearly the whole of that period in East and West Tennessee and Virginia. During the siege of Chattanooga, his regiment was compelled, for a time, to subsist on parched corn only, and were glad when they could get enough of it. For a long time previous to his death he had been an invalid, the result of a sun stroke in Baltimore. He was duly cognizant of the approach of the "grim destroyer," had made his peace with his Maker and took shelter under the "everlasting arms," with a child's implicit trust. While his aged parents believed that his death was but a question of a very short time,

yet, when it "came like a thief in the night," it was a great shock to them and brought darkness and gloom to the household.

This was followed on the 7th of January, 1881, by the death of Dr. Clarke McDermont, the husband of Mary Eliza, the third daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Winters. Clarke McDermont was born on the 12th of May, 1823, in the parish of Ballymony, County Antrim, Ireland. After receiving a liberal education, he emigrated to this country. Here he found himself without friends or money. As he was not afraid of work, he took the first that offered and began the world, as had his father-in-law, in a brick-yard. From this he branched off to other things, working faithfully and diligently until he succeeded in obtaining funds sufficient to secure for himself a thorough medical and surgical education. At the outbreak of the War of the Rebellion the doctor was among the first of those who, stirred by patriotic impulses, answered President Lincoln's first call for troops, and was appointed surgeon of the Second Ohio Volunteer Infantry. Leaving behind him wife, child, and a remunerative practice, he followed his regiment to Washington and engaged with it in the first battle of Bull Run.

From that time on to the close of the war, he was either engaged with marching regiments or in hospital service. On the establishment of the National Soldiers' Home, at Dayton, Dr. McDermont was appointed surgeon in charge, and remained in the hospital there and at Hampton, Virginia, until a year or so before his death when he resigned his position and resumed practice in Dayton. He had long been an invalid, the result of poisoned strawberries and cream, of which he, with other army officers, partook during the early stages of the war at the house of a rebel (fiend) in West Virginia. All of those who partook of those poisoned sweets were made ill, one died, and the doctor never fully recovered from their effects.

On the first of January, 1882, the banking firm of V. Winters & Son, after an eventful and measurably successful career of twenty-five years, lacking thirty-nine days, sold and transferred its business and good will to the Winters' National Bank, as will more fully appear from the following which we copy from the *Dayton Journal*:

"The Winters National Bank, of Dayton, was organized yesterday by the election of a strong board of directors and operating officers. Mr. Jonathan H. Winters, president, ranks among the

most capable bankers in the West. The cashier, Mr. J. C. Reber, has long been employed in the private bank of V. Winters & Son, and Mr. Leonard Moore, book-keeper, is universally known and respected for his estimable personal and business qualifications. While the capital stock of the bank is \$300,000, the stockholders represent more than ten times as much wealth. Besides the bank starts with a very large business built up during a long career of prosperity by Messrs. Valentine and Jonathan H. Winters. While the former apparently retires from the more active management of the business, he retains a large interest, and his services will be rendered in the board of directors, of which the following is a list :

"Directors — Valentine Winters, Jonathan H. Winters, E. Morgan Wood, Samuel Craighead, James D. Platt, L. B. Gunckel, James Stockstill, Jacob Decker, John M. Phelps.

"Officers — President, Jonathan H. Winters; vice-president, James D. Platt; cashier, James C. Reber."

We now come to the saddest part of this narrative, the death of our mother, which occurred on the 14th of April, 1882, at three o'clock A. M., after a prolonged illness. She had more than attained

the age prescribed by the psalmist of "three score years and ten," when she fell asleep in the blessed assurance of an eternal resurrection. The *Dayton Journal*, speaking of Mr. and Mrs. Winters, said:

"The tenor of their life has been equally smooth and happy. They have journeyed along side by side, beginning from the humblest circumstances, but were never separated from each other, and this final parting, though for some time expected, comes with a heavy blow to the husband. Three years ago they celebrated the fiftieth anniversary of their wedding, at which all their children and grandchildren were present. It was an auspicious and happy climax to so long and happy a union.

"Mrs. Winters and husband were among the earliest members of the Third Street Presbyterian Church. None were more anxious or solicitous for its welfare than she. She had a warm, earnest heart and ready hand, and when still poor in this world's goods, and with a large and growing family, she always found time to give encouragement and assistance to those about her. She leaves eight children and twenty-three grandchildren. The former of these are Mrs. R. R. Dickey, Mrs. N. B. Darst, Mrs. C. McDermont, Jonathan H. Winters, Mrs. L. B. Gunckel, Mrs. L. B. Eaton,

Mrs. R. McGregor, and Mrs. E. C. Shaw, all but two of whom now live in Dayton. The funeral of Mrs. Winters will take place to-morrow afternoon at 2:30, from the residence.

"Last evening the directors of the Winters National Bank held a special meeting, at which the following expression of sympathy was recorded:

"The directors of the Winters National Bank have learned with unfeigned sorrow of the death of Mrs. Catherine Harshman Winters, wife of their colleague, Mr. Valentine Winters, and mother of the president of the bank, and they desire to express to both their sincere sympathy in their great affliction. It is ordered that, as a mark of respect and sympathy, this bank be closed at one o'clock P. M. Saturday, April 15th, and that a copy of this expression be sent to the family of the deceased.'"

Sleep on, dear, dear mother, till the awakening shall come "in His likeness." The funeral services were conducted by the Reverend J. H. Montgomery, pastor of the Third Street Presbyterian Church. The pall-bearers were E. S. Forgy, J. W. Stoddard, W. J. Conklin, Warren Munger, A. C. Marshall, and Leonard Moore, and the precious remains were buried in Woodland Cemetery. The following "In

Memoriam," from the pen of a friend, is also copied from the *Dayton Journal*:

"Yesterday's declining sun lighted up one of the green hillsides in Woodland, where an open grave awaited the coming of its tenant. To a stranger's eye the scene was familiar—a family group bringing the quiet form of a loved one to its narrow resting-place. But there stood one in that company, watching the gentle hands that were burying his dead out of his sight, whose memory recalled the first scene in the panorama of this family history. In that scene she stood by his side—the wife of his youth. And after, came the day when the sacred name of mother was added to the honored title of wife. And as the canvas unrolled with the passing years, new faces appeared in the cradle, and the group about the fireside and the table grew larger. And so, as an 'heritage from the Lord,' there were born unto them sons and daughters.

"How rare must have been the memories that came to this aged father and husband! With increasing years, an increasing household and increasing substance; he, strong and vigorous in the busy enterprises of life; she, calm, patient, cheerful, ordering wisely the affairs of the home,

tender in all its ministries, courageous in all its trials, resigned in all its bereavements; through all experiences, and in spite of all experiences, hopeful to the end. How busily will his memory in the coming days of loneliness traverse and retrace the paths of this fifty-three years' journeying.

"And must he think that yesterday's sad ceremonies mark the end of her existence, and of this precious companionship? No, the coffin, the grave and the marble are but the conventional accessories of our departure. The closing hour of her earthly career was, to her, transition, not death. It was an hour of peace and joy and triumph; not an hour of gloom and sadness, but an hour for singing. Aye, an hour for singing! Her own voice failing, she asked others to sing, and thanked them for singing. It was given to the 'beloved disciple' to listen to the triumphant songs of the redeemed on the other side, and to re-echo them with his own voice; and down the centuries, since his day, the Lord's beloved ones 'shout their triumph as they go.'

"Mrs. Winters' life was thoroughly a home life, but many gracious and kindly influences went out from her life that were never connected with her

name. The writer has knowledge of charitable streams that flowed the fuller because fed from her hand. And now 'her children rise up and call her blessed, her husband also, and he praiseth her.'

"We wonder oftentimes at the placid expression on the face of an infant in its coffin. How much more wonderful to see the renewing of the youthful look on the face of one, who for more than half a century, had borne a wife and mother's burdens. Do we ask the secret of this peaceful expression, that remained like a written benediction on the cold face of this aged mother? It lies in the fact that her heart's experience is recorded in one of the last songs to which she listened, the night preceding her departure:

"I heard the voice of Jesus say,
"I am this dark world's light :
Look unto me : thy morn shall rise
And all thy day be bright."
I looked to Jesus, and I found
In Him my Star, my Sun ;
And in that light of life I'll walk,
Till traveling days are done.'

"Be comforted, then, bereaved husband; be consoled, weeping children. Be hopeful all, and

cheerful. Honor the memory of the wife and mother who has gone before, by attuning your own lives to the same music that cheered her departing hour. Remember how eagerly she anticipated rejoining the loved ones who had preceded her. Can you doubt that she will hopefully await your coming? The changed fashion of her countenance—from pain to peace—as it last appeared to your eyes, carries the promise of a brighter transfiguration. For shall not they who sleep in Jesus, awake in His likeness? And shall not the body of our humiliation, also, be changed, and made like unto His own glorious body? How appropriate that the wearied body should have been carried to its repose, on the day whose observance was first enjoined as a day of rest; and whose weekly return now commemorates the resurrection of our Lord from the tomb.

“The old, old fashion. The fashion that came in with our first parents, and will last unchanged until our race has run its course, and the wide firmament is rolled up like a scroll. The old, old fashion—Death. Oh, thank God, all who see it, for the older fashion yet of Immortality.”

Shortly after the death of Mrs. Catharine Winters, and in consequence of it, the bereaved hus-

band called his children about him, and, with broken voice, announced his intention of dividing between them all of his deceased wife's estate, together with more than an equal portion of his own. We append herewith the *Dayton Journal's* report of this memorable gathering:

"Mr. Valentine Winters, acting as the executor of the will of his wife recently deceased, made a division of her real estate combining with it a large amount of valuable property of his own. Mrs. Winters, in her will, gave Mr. Winters discretion to sell her real estate according to his judgment; the proceeds of it and her personal property, consisting of stocks and bonds, to be divided among her children. Mr. Winters, desiring that the real estate owned by his wife should remain in the family, and finding that it was not divisible into eight equal portions, decided to equalize the division by distributing to their children the larger part of his own real estate in this city and county.

"He also gave to each a considerable sum of money, which, with the real estate and previous cash advances, made each share amount to the sum of fifty thousand four hundred and fifty dollars, the total for the eight children being four hundred and three thousand six hundred dollars. Of this amount,

one hundred and ninety-three thousand dollars was from the estate of Mrs. Winters.

"Mr. Winters invited his family, consisting of one son and one daughter-in-law, seven daughters and five sons-in-law, to dinner yesterday, and after dinner made the distributions, handing to each a package containing the necessary deeds and insurance policies, together with a check for each one's share of money.

"Mr. Leonard Moore, for many years in the bank of V. Winters & Son, of well-known reputation as an accountant, and who is also a practical conveyancer, had been for the last two weeks engaged in the examination of titles and preparation of the deeds, and was present to assist in the delivery of the deeds and to prepare the necessary receipts and other papers.

"The occasion was most unusual, and Mr. Winters looked a very patriarch surrounded by the stalwart men and women of his household. Their names are as follows: Mr. and Mrs. Jonathan H. Winters, Mrs. Mary E. McDermont, Mrs. Laura W. McGregor, Mr. and Mrs. N. B. Darst, Mr. and Mrs. R. R. Dickey, Hon. and Mrs. Lewis B. Gunckel, Col. and Mrs. L. B. Eaton, and Mr. and Mrs. E. C. Shaw. Mr. Winters was the recipient of affectionate kisses and hearty thanks."

XIII

On the evening of the 8th of the following August (1882), Mr. J. H. Winters, the only surviving son of Valentine Winters, started westward, accompanied by his family, consisting of a wife, two daughters and one son, to accomplish a journey he had long had in contemplation. It was to make a tour around the world. He had previously resigned his position as president of the Winters' National Bank and Valentine Winters was chosen to fill the vacancy. His aged father accompanied them to the depot to give them his blessing and benediction, and to wish them God-speed on a journey, of which only Omnipotent power could forecast the issue. With heavy hearts, the farewells were spoken, and at six o'clock they boarded the train which soon moved slowly westward out of the depot. The reporter of the *Dayton Journal*, one year later, thus summarizes the particulars of their journey:

"AROUND THE WORLD.

"After a remarkable tour, accomplished exactly in one year, the Winter's family arrive safe at home.

"At exactly six o'clock last evening Mr. J. H. Winters and family, consisting of Mrs. Winters, two daughters and son, arrived home after a tour of exactly one year among the principal foreign countries. In this time they visited the leading places of interest, points of historical note, and had many of the novel experiences which are known only to tourists in foreign lands. The party left Dayton on the 8th of August, 1882, leaving the city from the west, and returning in just three hundred and sixty-five days from the east. From Dayton they went to Colorado, Salt Lake City, and San Francisco, where several weeks were spent before their departure for Japan on the steamer 'Coptic.' The voyage was accomplished in twenty days, during which period they had their first experience in a sea gale, and obtained a very vivid idea of the vicissitudes and unpleasantries of marine travel. This was, however, no more than a breeze in comparison to a cyclone which they subsequently encountered in the Bay of Bengal. Arriving in Japan, in the loveliest October weather, not greatly different from that in this latitude, they spent a month pleasantly among this people. They were particularly impressed with the beauties of the country

and the agreeable customs of the people, and it was with regret, perhaps, that they left the island for China. Eight or ten days were spent in Shanghai, and two weeks in Canton, Hong Kong, and Macoa. Here they were given ample opportunity to observe the manners and habits of the people and visit places of interest. They found in China not an unimportant American colony, by whom they were welcomed in the heartiest manner. From China they proceeded to Singapore and the Isle of Ceylon, with which they were especially pleased. Mr. Winters stated that he found the famed perfumed breezes of Ceylon no poetical fancy, but that when fully half a day's journey from the island the aroma of spices was wafted to them on board the vessel.

"After a pleasant stay in Ceylon, they went to India, landing at Madras, and proceeding thence to Calcutta. They had now been gone some five months, but the various scenes and constantly changing wonders left for them no desire to return. From Calcutta they traveled to the Himalaya Mountains, and saw the second highest peak in the world, Mount Kinchongunga. This, with its crest shrouded among the clouds, and covered with perpetual snow, was one of the grandest sights of

the journey. The tour of India consumed six weeks, in which time they visited all the leading cities, with the exception of Lucknow, which was then infested with small-pox. Leaving India they crossed the Arabian Sea to Suez, and there took cars to Cairo. Here they climbed the pyramids and obtained a partial view of the former kingdom of the Ptolemies, but were too late to make the trip of the Nile, the last boat having ascended before their arrival. From Egypt they visited Palestine, spending a month in the Holy Land. They found it the most barren country they ever saw, covered with rocks and wastes, and with a single garden plot on the road from Jericho to Bethel, where beautiful and strange wild flowers relieve the monotony. A peculiarity of the government of Palestine is the taxation of trees, and for this reason there is little vegetation. The Bedouins cut down all but a few stunted olive trees in order to escape the tax. Five days were spent in Jerusalem, which they found to be an interesting city, much to their gratification. The tour of Palestine was made in company with fourteen others, who formed an excursion party. From Jerusalem they visited the Dead Sea, Jericho, Bethel, Jacob's Well, and historic places in and about Nazareth. The

latter they found to be quite a large city, but one of the dirtiest in the world. Samaria was the next point of interest, and thence they visited the Sea of Galilee, the Waters of Marim, and finally proceeded across Mount Hermon to Damascus, the oldest city in the world. Here they remained four days, and thence went to Baalbec and Beirout. In crossing the Lebanon Mountains they were overtaken by a terrific rain and snow storm, which continued two days, and when they finally arrived at a place of shelter they had been subjected to severe exposure, though fortunately they felt no serious effects. At Beirout they took a steamer for Constantinople, touching on the way at Cyprus, Rhodes, and Smyrna. At Constantinople they obtained a passing view of the Sultan, who was at the Mosque for devotion, though as Mr. Winters expressed it, they were somewhat ashamed at their own curiosity to see a ruler, whose authority extended chiefly over a harem, and who bowed at the beck of other governments. Five days were passed in this capital of the Mohammedans, and they then went to Athens, from whence they proceeded to Corinth and Naples. At the latter city they remained ten days, and being in the month of May, it was one of the pleasantest periods in their jour-

ney. From Naples the party went to Rome, the city of the seven hills, where two weeks were devoted to sight-seeing among the ruins of the old Roman capital. From this historic place they went to Pisa, where the principal curiosity was the famous leaning tower, thence to Florence, where they tarried a week, and then to Venice, where five days more of sight-seeing were consumed. Milan was reached next and a delightful trip made to the pretty lakes of Italy, chief among them being Lake Como. The tourists then passed into the country of the hardy Swiss, where one week of rain and the prospect of no cessation, induced them to leave the Alps in their mist-crowned glory and witness the scenes of Parisian life. Two weeks were given to seeing the gay capital, and they then passed two more among the dikes and ditches, the battle-fields and cities of Holland and Belgium. At Amsterdam they visited the national exposition, in progress, and in Belgium stood upon the field of Waterloo. From Brussels they went directly to Calais, on the French coast and crossed the strait to London, where they remained sixteen days, not going into the interior or visiting Scotland and Wales, but leaving the great capital on the 25th of July, and

on the following day taking the steamer "City of Berlin" at Liverpool, on the home passage. A delay of ten hours at Queenstown, awaiting the mail for America, enabled them to pay a short visit to Cork. With fair weather they sighted American soil in ten days, and arrived in New York last Sunday. On the following Tuesday they took cars for home, and saw no more welcome sight perhaps in all their travels than that dismal old union depot, when they alighted in it last evening.

"During their tour they had been ninety-one days on the ocean, and had traversed forty thousand miles of land and water. All this had been accomplished with few misfortunes and little ill-health, and in this it is a remarkable journey as in other respects. In Japan and at Naples they had distinctly felt earthquakes; but with all the strange countries and people visited they had only three days of delay. No accident worth mention happened them, except to Mrs. Winters, who fell from the horse she was riding in Palestine. Her injuries were but slight.

"Last evening Mr. Winters' residence was thrown open to the friends of the family, and for hours they were besieged with numbers who had learned

of their safe arrival and called to give them happy greeting and congratulations upon their welcome return.

The return of the "Globe Trotters" was followed a few months later (January 15, 1884,) by the marriage of one of them. The following notice of this auspicious event in the history of two lives was published in the *Dayton Journal* on the following morning:

"Mr. Allen E. Thomas and Miss Louella, elder daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Jonathan H. Winters, of this city, were married last evening at the residence of the bride's parents, on West Third Street. Messrs. Oscar F. Davisson and Mark Morton, of Chicago, and Miss Clara Winters, sister of the bride, and Miss Fanny Smith were the attendants. Rev. J. H. Montgomery, pastor of the Third Street Presbyterian Church—of which the bride and groom are members—officiated, assisted by the Rev. Dr. David Winters, the venerable great-uncle of the bride.

"The ceremony was brief and tasteful and the wedding altogether beautiful.

"The bride was attired in a white brocade silk, purchased by her in China during their journey last year. The costumes of her attendant sister

Clara, and of Mrs. Winters, were also purchased there. Miss Smith wore a beautiful dress of pink and blue silk—very much admired by the ladies.

“The guests were about equally divided between numerous family connections, and the middle-aged and older class of citizens, with a few of the bride’s associates and some strangers from other localities, among whom were Mr. Duhme, wife and daughter, and Mr. Harvey and wife, of Cincinnati, and Mr. Rowland and wife, of Toledo. Conspicuous in the throng was the handsome and venerable grandfather of the bride, Valentine Winters, Esq., who received the greetings of hosts of friends with that agreeable urbanity which all his life has made him a favorite in Dayton society.

“Eloquent and appropriate music, with all other agreeable accessories of such an occasion, made it as pleasing as could be desired.

“After the guests had said good-night, Mr. and Mrs. Thomas repaired to their beautiful home—a present from the bride’s parents—on the southwest corner of Fifth and Wilkinson streets. The groom, we may add, is a worthy young gentleman, well known in Dayton society. His occupation is that of cashier and book-keeper for John Dodds & Company’s Agricultural Works. The best wishes

of a large circle of friends are extended to the happy couple."

The children of this marriage are Jonathan Winters and Clara Olive.

Again the sound of wedding bells reaches our ears, but faintly, as no invitations were extended to witness the ceremony. Laura W. McGregor, *née* Winters, was married to James C. Reber, of Dayton, Ohio, on the 8th of April, 1884. Mr. Reber, when but a lad of fifteen, had caught the patriotic fever then so prevalent, and entered the army at an early stage of the War of the Great Rebellion, and had demonstrated his love of country on the bloody, yet victorious, fields of Donaldson, Shiloh, and Vicksburg.

Although many times under fire, he was never hit, except by Cupid's darts after the war. He was at this time the cashier of the Winters National Bank. The ceremony was performed by the Rev. David Winters, D. D.

It now becomes our sad duty to chronicle the death of David, the eldest brother and former instructor of Valentine Winters, which occurred Saturday evening, May 9, 1885. The following is from the *Dayton Journal*:

"Although for several years afflictions incident to

old age were creeping upon the Rev. David Winters, D. D., of this city, and it was generally known that for the past three weeks he had been seriously ill; announcement of his death Saturday night was a shock to the community, and to-day the people mourn the loss of the beloved pastor.

“To give a sketch of the life of the Rev. David Winters, or a simple narrative of the great good accomplished by him in the many years of active church work, would fill a volume with interesting matter, closely interwoven with the progress of Christianity in this valley, and of all important events in the history of the county for seventy years past. This noble old man, so well known to the good people of the county, had a warmer place in the hearts of the multitude than any other living person. This position is his unchallenged, earned in so long a life of constant effort for the good of his fellow-man, in the name of the Master. There is scarcely a neighborhood in this valley in which his preaching is not familiar, and where he has not aided in building a church. He was known to and venerated by the younger generations of our people as Father Winters. By the old settlers in all neighborhoods of the valley he was known and beloved as Brother Winters.

“He has ministered consolation to the fathers, officiated at the marriages of the children of the third and fourth generations, and to the sick and distressed has been a rock in the hour of trial, a faithful sentinel pointing to the promises and blessings of the Bible. The great work of his life is attested by the numbers that his preaching have rallied to the faithful support under the banners of Christianity.

“For such as he it is written: ‘Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the Lord forever.’

“David, son of the Rev. Thomas Winters, was born at Martinsburg, Berkeley County, West Virginia, December 24, 1801, and came with his parents to Ohio in 1809, and settled on land in Mad-river Township, Montgomery County. In the fall of 1815 the family moved to Germantown, the father to become pastor of the German Reformed Church.

“David received his education and studied for the ministry under instructions of his father; and in 1824, under a call from church people at Dayton and vicinity, he entered the ministry, and was ordained at New Philadelphia, Ohio, and in October, 1824, he removed to Dayton and at once began the

organization of the German Reformed Church, services to be conducted in the German language. On the 11th of January following, he married Mary Ann, daughter of William and Lydia Huffman, of Dayton.

"The feeble little colony of Christians were first gathered for services in the court room, in the little brick court-house, at the corner of Main and Third streets; then, as the congregation increased in numbers, they rented the Christian Church that stood on the west side of Main Street, at the northwest corner of the first alley south of Fourth Street. There they continued to worship until they built the church that the congregation yet use, on the east side of Ludlow Street, at the south corner of the first alley north of Third Street. Services were held alternately in the German and English languages, and two full sets of officers, German and English elders and deacons, were elected.

"For twenty-seven years Mr. Winters was pastor of the church. A charter for the congregation was granted by the legislature January 13, 1836. April 18, 1837, the ground, now occupied by the church on Ludlow Street, between Second and Third, was bought of George W. Simonds for \$700. Peter Baer, Frederick Boyer, and Valentine Winters were

appointed as a building committee, and in August, 1837, the corner stone was laid, and the fine brick church was finished. The church was dedicated during the session of the Synod, which convened here June 7, 1840. The dedicatory sermons were preached by Rev. George Weisz, in German, and Rev. Henry Willard, in English.

"Zion Church, in Section 10, about four miles south of Dayton, on the Miamisburg pike, was one of the churches fostered by the Rev. Thomas Winters, first worshiping with the congregation at Miamisburg and Germantown, then organizing with a view of establishing a church of their own.

"David's Church, in Van Buren Township, about two and a half miles northeast of Zion's, near the Lebanon pike; Mount Zion, about a mile east of Beavertown, on the Indian Ripple road, and Hawker's Church, in Greene County, about five miles east of Dayton, on the Xenia pike, were established by colonies from the Zion Congregation.

"The latter named congregation, with the First Reformed Church people of Dayton, in 1824 united in the call to the Rev. David Winters to become their regular pastor. As has been stated, he accepted the call, was ordained to preach, and in the fall of that year entered upon the duties, and

for sixty-one years was their faithful, untiring minister of the gospel.

“David’s Church was organized by Mr. Winters in 1825, the congregation assembling at the cabins of members for worship until a meeting-house was built. Christian Creager was the first elder. He gave the land for the church, and the logs to build it, the members uniting in getting out the timbers and raising the cabin church. It was named David’s Church in honor of their pastor, who continued to serve as such for over fifty years.

“Mount Zion and Hawker’s, both large congregations, were built in later years.

“For many years Mr. Winters was pastor for the four churches, but old age coming on, he gave up preaching at David’s and Hawker’s, but continued the active and beloved leader of the congregations at Zion and Mount Zion until the day of his death.

“Upon Mr. Winters’ beginning his ministry in Dayton, he also became active with other Christians of the town in the general church work. Monday, January 2, 1826, he was elected president of the Montgomery County Bible Society, and was continued in that position for five years. The other officers of the society for the year 1826 were: Vice-presidents, William King, of the Presby-

terians; Aaron Baker, of the Methodists, and Colonel Robert Patterson, of the Newlights; David Osborn, recording secretary; Dr. Job Haines, corresponding secretary; Luther Bruen, treasurer; directors, James Steele, Daniel Pier-son, David Reid, J. H. Williams, O. B. Conover, Stephen Fales, Dr. John Steele, John Patterson, George S. Houston, S. B. Cleveland, James Slaght, Christian Oblinger. All of whom are long since dead.

“Father Winters’ church duties and visits to his parishioners necessitated regular and extended horseback rides to the different neighborhoods, often at a distance of fifty or sixty miles. Thus had he been in active church work for these many years, having in his field of labor so large a territory that of later years it was divided and sub-divided until now there are sixteen strong, influential, self-supporting charges which he organized, and sixteen churches erected, with which he was associated.

“In his pastoral career it was a common thing for him to travel on horseback from two thousand to three thousand miles a year, or a total of one hundred and sixty-five thousand miles, visiting the sick and needy, spreading the light of the gospel

through the cabin settlements, preaching in the cabins and barns, or in the open air, with the log heap for his pulpit, and by the burning brush fires at night, giving encouragement to the little bands of Christians in the scattered neighborhoods, and organizing congregations; often administering the Lord's Supper to his people with nothing but the broad canopy of heaven above them.

"He preached eight thousand sermons, officiated at one thousand three hundred funerals, baptized three thousand persons, and added to his own church communion, by the right of confirmation, two thousand four hundred persons. The lowest number during any one year was twenty, the highest one hundred and fifty-five. In the discharge of his duties he administered the Lord's Supper to twenty-two thousand one hundred and fifty communicants; and, in connection with his labors, united in marriage five thousand and ninety couples, the last ceremony of this kind occurring April 22d, less than a month ago.

"Father Winters had been for many years prominently identified with the Heidelberg College and Seminary at Tiffin, O., which institution several years ago did itself, as well as him, distinguished honor by conferring upon him the degree of D. D.

“With the improvement of the country, he witnessed the steady increase of the Reformed Church from a handful of Christians to a score of thrifty, influential congregations, worshiping in comfortable, modern edifices, in charge of a younger generation of zealous, able preachers. As a result of his labors in gaining accessions to the church by baptism and confirmation, he was instrumental in the organization of sixteen congregations, located in Montgomery, Greene, and Miami counties, all of which have substantial church buildings, have regular pastors, and are self-sustaining. The Dayton church has five hundred and twenty-seven communicants, which is probably larger than any other Protestant congregation of the city. In this the Miami Classis, Ohio Synod, Reformed Church, there are also twenty other strong congregations that have grown from the churches organized and ministered by Father Winters, and go towards building the mighty monument of his life’s work.

“Thus has ended a long and useful life, interaffiliated with thousands of others: some that closed when it was yet high noon with the patriarch, others with whom the sun is fast westering, while a vast multitude to whom his life work had been

helpful, pause to note the fall of that erect form that even the infirmities of age bowed not.

“It will take more than a half century to remove Dr. Winters from the present, and it will be then a promotion to an exalted place in the history of Montgomery County, of the churches of this valley, and of the denominations of which he was an honored minister, that jealous fate accords to but few men. Sixty-one years of continuous pastorate in the same field of labor, a life well on to a century in length, and the mantle of a prophet resting on his shoulders since a boy of twenty, is a destiny of almost unparalleled success.

“Rest well, then, beloved patriarch of the church, while numberless friends draw near to say farewell. The aged and the young are filled with reverential awe as they look upon your ashes. Your work, well done, secures eternal rest.

“You witnessed not the planting, but the growth of civilization, wealth, and culture in this great valley, and your contribution to her welfare was weal, your inheritance lasting honor, and from ten thousand scenes of sorrow and ten thousand sacred joys we bring grateful hearts, and say well done. God giveth his beloved sleep.”

The funeral sermon was preached by Rev. Isaac

H. Reiter, of Miamisburg, after which the Rev. W. A. Hale delivered an eloquent eulogy, of which the following is an abstract:

"A man's life is a lamp. When we stand in the shadow of death and hold that life up to illuminate the way of his departure, his life is a legacy. We come to bury Dr. Winters, not to praise him. Solemn as is this duty, we must distinguish between what ought to be buried and what is the inheritance of the race. 'No man liveth to himself.' Selfish as we may be, earnestly as we may strive, that only is ours that we incorporate into our being; that, while death might divest us of our mortality, it remains an inwrought virtue of our moral and intellectual constitution.

"The life-work of Dr. Winters belongs to the race. Our lives are either treasures or trash. We make the race richer or impoverish it as we contribute vice or virtue to the sum total of human experience. Dr. Winters' contribution to this world, to the people and churches of this valley, was love's tenderest offices and mercy's kindest benedictions. We do not attempt the interment of that life-work in the bosom of that impartial mother, where these ashes will find quiet and peaceful rest. The churches he has established

are living things; the institutions he has founded are immortal, and these will remain, though generations pass away and empires perish. We, as members of the Miami Classis, have entered into those labors. Four thousand communicant members are in the territory that comprised his first charge, and elders and deacons, I know not how many. Not a charge, not a congregation but has living representatives, ruling elders, deacons, and teachers, upon whose brow he sprinkled the water of holy baptism. He trained them in the doctrines and duties of our holy religion, received them at the altar, and consecrated them to God and welcomed them at a first communion into full membership in the church of Christ. The honor before God is his, the pleasures and joys of success are his, but the wealth of treasure in this visible kingdom is ours, as Christ is ours. No! no! no! This legacy we will not attempt to inter.

"Dr. Winters has gone, and in the mute majesty of death we yet know he lives: lives in the work he has inaugurated; lives in the agencies he has appointed; lives in the excellency of human gratitude, devotion, and honor. We sometimes think man's place is filled when death makes a vacancy. This is error. There are no vacancies in life. God

has no reserve of humanity, idle and unoccupied, from which to fill the vacancies which death appears to make. Every man must fill his own place, and, if he be faithful to the trust, his duty will occupy all his time, talent, and toil. Dear hearer, you have neither time, place, nor opportunity in which to do another's work. The labor you ought to do, for your own and others' good, no one can do for you. The thought that it is possible has made you idle, but you will go to judgment with your work undone. So it is now that Dr. Winters met the responsibility of life, discharged the debt of duty, and has won the approbation, 'Well done, good and faithful servant.' He, with his father, his brother, T. H., the three pioneer ministers of the Reformed Church in this valley, preaching the gospel in cabins, barns, and under the shadow of gigantic trees, accomplished that which has made them immortal. While there is a history of the Reformed Church in the United States, the names of these men will be household words.

"Rev. David Winters was more than an average man. What man in Southern Ohio has gained a wider fame than he? Rev. David Winters is known from coast to coast, and from the lakes to the gulf. He gained at the hands of that exact

science, history, a place that in her jealousy she accords to but few men and confers her honors on merit. She writes only such names as are necessary to complete the record of the race, and without which history would be incomplete. Dr. Winters was a great man; great in this valley, great in the Reformed Church. What countless scenes of joy he has graced! Into how many dark shadows he has shined the gospel of peace and consolation.

"A gentleman in business in our city, speaking of Dr. Winters yesterday, said: 'You ought to have known him when he was a man in his prime, standing at such a time when the sun casts no shadow, his person erect, graceful, noble. He looked the preacher; he was a preacher. His voice, as sound as the notes of a well-played flute and as tender as a maiden's; his face, a flood of warm sunshine, his genial manners drawing men into esteem and respect for the man of God. The art of making friends was nature asserting herself, the power by which he held them was the magnetism of honesty.'

"Every nook and corner of Montgomery County and of the Reformed Church in the United States is vocal with his praise. A great man has fallen in Israel this day! His own words illustrate the

triumph of this closing scene. A few weeks since I met this aged man, trembling with weakness, and when I expressed sorrow at the infirmities of age, he replied: 'The day is nearly ended.' I then said: 'I trust that the sunset will be clear.' His reply was: 'The clouds are all above the horizon, the sun sinks into a sea of gold.'

"Sleep well, thou patriarch! Sleep well! Your work is well done; your triumph is complete. Our tribute, gratitude and memory's tenderest and fondest recollections. You are absent now, only because a messenger from the throne eternal has ordered you into the presence of the King. The ceremony of coronation awaits your coming. Go! Our loss is your gain."

On the morning of the twenty-third of August, 1885, the "grim destroyer" again invaded Mr. Winters' household and took therefrom his beloved daughter, Clara, the wife of L. B. Eaton. She had come to her father's house on her annual summer visit, little thinking that she would never again return to her own home in Memphis. For years she had been more or less of an invalid, but was always cheerful and made light of her failing health, and although she rested her hopes in the merits of a crucified but risen Lord and Savior,

she still clung to life for the sake of her husband and son. When conscious that her end was approaching, she submitted to the inevitable without a murmur and entered into rest with that quiet resignation which had characterized her life. She was a faithful wife and mother, a loving sister and a kind friend.

XIV.

ABOUT the middle of March, 1886, Mr. Winters, though in his seventy-ninth year and somewhat feeble, determined to take a trip to California. He had long had this journey in view, and as all things were then favorable, invited Mrs. McDermont, Mr. and Mrs. J. H. Winters, Miss Clara Winters, and Valentine Winters, Jr., to accompany him. The distances between stopping places were great, but, to the surprise of the party, he never seemed to tire and endured the fatigue with better courage than they. He apparently enjoyed every moment of the long journey, and did all that he could to make it a pleasant one, not only to the members of his own party, but to all who journeyed with him in the same direction. When stopped in the mountains beyond Barstow by a land slide, with

an exhausted lunch basket, he purveyed for the party by getting into the good graces of a widow, from Santa Barbara, who placed at his disposal a share of her abundant supply of lunch.

His trip took in Kansas City, Los Vegas, San Diego, Los Angeles, Monterey, San Francisco, Salt Lake City, Denver, and Chicago, and the only drawback to his complete enjoyment of it was the occasional illness of his daughter, Mrs. McDermont, first noticed after she had taken a hot bath in Los Vegas, New Mexico. She, however, with the spirit of a martyr, concealed the pain that was sapping her life, so that the party did not know, till after her death, how much she must have suffered.

The travelers reached home safely in the early part of May, and a few days later, whilst Mr. Winters was off at Pelee Island with the Dayton fishing club, Mrs. McDermont took to her bed and soon her malady assumed a dangerous type. He was summoned to her side, and she rapidly grew worse until the 28th of May, when she died.

The following tributes to the memory of Mary Eliza McDermont are from the columns of the *Dayton Journal*:

"Sculptured in relief, on a granite block, in quiet

‘Woodland,’ is an open book; and on its first page is chiseled the record:

“‘CLARKE McDERMONT, M. D.,
1823—1881.’

“Since the date that marks the termination of the earthly life of him who sleeps there, the annual recurrence of this May day, has seen that granite page, and the sod beneath it, garlanded with flowers; for Clarke McDermont was a soldier. But his duty on the battle-field was to heal the wounds that other soldiers made, and to staunch the flow of blood that others shed. Such a soldier he was, and more: for he was a Christian, and he had held official rank in the army of that Captain whose highest title is, ‘Prince of Peace.’

“To-day the hands that have brought to his grave these annual tributes to his memory are folded over the heart that loved him; and the sod has been cut, that by his mouldering clay may be laid the sleeping form of her who called him husband. And now the craftsman will come and carve on that open page the name —

“‘MARY ELIZA McDERMONT,’

and the dates that mark the beginning and end of her journey ‘under the sun.’

"Let the writer, on this Decoration Day, tell the fact that in the hospitals, both in the city and in the field, this devoted wife shared her husband's labors; and by the tender ministry of her hands and the gracious cheer of her presence and her words reinforced his work.

"There was privation in this, and danger, too, but she did not shrink or hesitate. There was something she could do, and there was the occasion; she made the opportunity, instead of waiting for it. And now that she is to be laid to rest, on this commemorative day, by the side of him who loved her, and whose heroic labors she had shared, it is a grateful task to offer these poor words of tribute to her memory.

"Since those days of 'the pomp and circumstance' of war, the life of Mrs. McDermont has been one that called for the exercise of those qualities with which she was pre-eminently endowed. For years she was the blessed helpmeet of her invalid husband; more than nurse, better than physician.

"More recently the marriage of her son, and his establishment in his separate home, left her free to return to the home of her father, whose loneliness in his old age demanded just the help

which her companionship could afford him. Her cheerful, active, buoyant nature seemed the very buttress he needed in his life's declension.

'Blest with a temper whose unclouded ray,
Can make to-morrow cheerful as to-day,'

it seemed as if it was the special ordering of Providence that she should walk by her father's side, to cheer and comfort him to the close of his journey; but, alas for human calculations, how often is the picture presented—

'— weeping fathers build their children's tomb.'

"Mrs. McDermont was a member of the First Presbyterian Church, but since she returned to her father's house she usually attended worship with him, in the Third Street Church. She, however, continued actively identified with the First Church, and was especially efficient in the work of the Ladies' Missionary Society, at whose meetings her presence and example were an inspiration, and where her catholic spirit and sound judgment were always helpful.

"While the special observances of to-day teach us that 'The path of glory leads but to the grave,' this particular providence emphasizes and broadens the lesson if we will but read it, and reminds us

that all human histories have a common ending, and that all human paths converge to one narrow resting-place. In all the sadness of this bereavement, to the son and father, and the brother and sisters, thank God, there is no bitterness; for it is the adding of one more name to the innumerable company of those who are sleeping in Jesus.

“‘Asleep in Jesus—time nor space
Debars this precious hiding-place;
On India's plains, or Lapland snows,
Believers find the same repose.’

“Mrs. McDermont's army life is described as follows: She was born in Dayton on the 27th of October, 1832, and on November 12, 1856, married Dr. Clarke McDermont, then a prominent physician in Dayton, afterward surgeon of the 2d Ohio Volunteers, and 43d Ohio Infantry, being parts of the Army of the Cumberland. After the battle of Perryville, Mrs. McDermont hastened to join her husband, and the suffering of the sick and wounded so enlisted her sympathies that she devoted herself thereafter to their relief, as entirely as if she had been a professional nurse and as devotedly as any “Sister of Charity.” The field for work was soon extended, as her husband was placed in charge of Cumberland Hospital, at Nashville, which had an

average of three thousand patients, and subsequently of the army hospitals at Louisville, where he remained until 1864. Mrs. McDermont remained with him all the time, and hundreds of sick and wounded soldiers had reason to thank Heaven for sending them a friend so ready and willing, so capable and courageous—one who could aid in alleviating their sufferings and help them to bear them by kind words and Christian counsel.

“At the close of the war, Dr. McDermont was placed in charge of the hospital at Camp Dennison, and his Christian, devoted wife again shared the labors and duties of that work until the Doctor was made Surgeon General of Ohio.

“On the establishment of the Soldiers’ Home, Dr. McDermont was made one of its first surgeons, and remained in charge of the hospitals at Dayton and Hampton until near his death in 1881; and what a ‘ministering angel’ his good wife proved to the thousands of disabled soldiers at these Homes during those ten years, there are hundreds of veterans only too willing to tell.

“Rarely has it been given a woman to have had such opportunities for doing good; still more rarely have such opportunities been so willingly embraced, so fully and perfectly improved.

"Since her husband's death her work has been less public and less extended, but no less earnest—no less devoted to doing good. She was a member of the Presbyterian Church, but her Christianity was shown not so much in profession as in practice. All her life she followed the example of Him who 'went about doing good.'

"If her peculiar character could be expressed in any one word, it would be 'unselfishness.' This was exemplified all through her active life, and beautifully emphasized during her last sickness. Although at times suffering great pain, she never complained; and, although conscious of her approaching death, she seemed to wholly forget herself and think and care only for the comfort, welfare, and pleasure of others.

"Among many examples of this fact that might be named, let one suffice. Several times during the last days of her sickness she stated that if, after her death, her friend and physician, Dr. Reeve, thought a post mortem examination would benefit science and save others from like suffering, she gave her free consent, and asked that her friends interpose no objection to its being done.

"Had Mrs. McDermont lived in an earlier age, and belonged to an earlier church, her Christian

faith and works, her unselfish life and glorious death would have entitled her to a place among those declared 'saints.'"

XV.

At the opening of the new Board of Trade rooms, which occurred Tuesday, February 21, 1888, among other addresses delivered on that occasion, was the following on "Reminiscences of Early Banking in Dayton," by the editor of these papers, which is reproduced here because of the interaffiliations of Valentine Winters with the business life on which it dwells:

"It is only fair to say, before perpetrating these rambling reminiscences upon you, that, in selecting me to be the exponent of the banking interests of Dayton, the committee of the Board of Trade did not do so because of any peculiar or personal fitness of mine for the task, but rather from the fact that my life and experience as a banker, still in the harness, reaches farther back than that of any of the Dayton bankers similarly situated, and that they might thus admonish me that I am a veteran in the service, and fast growing to be a veteran in years.

"The first company organized in Dayton with banking privileges was the Dayton Manufacturing Company, with H. G. Phillips as president, and George S. Houston as cashier. It was opened for business August 18, 1814, and, although compelled by the exigencies of the times, more than once, to suspend specie payment, continued with varying success until August 8, 1831, when a change was made and the business thereafter carried on under the name of the Dayton Bank. On the 3d of January, 1843, because of the expiration of its charter, its directors were made trustees to close up the affairs of the bank. The stone banking house, occupied and owned by the bank from the beginning to the close of its career, is still standing on North Main Street, and is occupied as a dwelling by our esteemed fellow-citizen, Joseph Bimm. The Dayton Bank passed unscathed through a period of unusual prostration in business, and closed its affairs with honor to its officers and without loss to the public, an unusual result for those unsettled times.

"H. G. Phillips resigned the presidency of the bank November 10, 1814, and Joseph Peirce was appointed in his place. On the death of Joseph Peirce, in September, 1821, B. Van Cleve was made

president. Mr. Van Cleve lived but one or two months after his election, and was succeeded by Colonel George Newcom in November of that year. James Steele was made president February 14, 1823, and continued to hold the office until his death, in August, 1841. James Perrine succeeded him and held the office until the bank closed up. The death of George S. Houston, cashier, was announced to the board May 24, 1831, and Charles R. Greene was appointed cashier. July 5, 1831, Alexander Grimes was made cashier and held the office until the bank closed, when he was made trustee to close up its affairs. D. Z. Peirce, D. H. Bruen, Joseph A. DuSang, and John Harries filled positions in the bank at different periods.

“The historian of the Dayton National Bank, Mr. W. S. Phelps, to whose researches I am indebted for many of the foregoing facts and from whom I have freely quoted, failed to make a clear case in his effort to connect, by regular descent, the existing Dayton National Bank, with the old original Dayton Manufacturing Company. There is a missing link, or a gap of over three years from the time when the old Dayton Bank asked its depositors to withdraw their balances until the

passage of the bank charter in 1845, which authorized both the Dayton Branch of the State Bank of Ohio and the new Dayton Bank to commence business.

"These banks both opened for business in the spring of 1845, and the following circumstance is, I think, the "missing link" which connects, not the Dayton National Bank, but the Winters National Bank in a direct line with the Dayton Manufacturing Company.

"In 1842, the old Dayton Bank paid to Jonathan Harshman, in lieu of his deposits and stock, about forty-five thousand dollars in silver. This was taken from the old bank at night, on a dray, by Valentine Winters and Abraham Overlease, and placed in the vault of the room now occupied by Jerry Wollaston's cigar store, where it remained undisturbed until the new Dayton Bank organized for business in that same room, with Jonathan Harshman for president, and Valentine Winters, cashier. It was then paid into the new bank as a part of its capital stock. Thus it would appear that this link of silver completes the chain which connects in unbroken succession the old Dayton Manufacturing Company with the bank which I have the honor to represent to-day.

"Peter Odlin was the first president, and D. Z. Peirce the first cashier of the Dayton Branch of the State Bank of Ohio. Later on, in 1850 or 1851, the Miami Valley Bank was organized, with Daniel Beckel as president and S. C. Emley as cashier.

"This is, as nearly as I can get at the facts, a statement of all the banks that had been organized up to the year 1853. In the fall of that year my banking experience began.

"It was a year of great currency inflation. The "wild cat" currency of Indiana, the "red dog" of Illinois and Michigan, to say nothing of the nondescript issues of other States, our own not excluded, had filled all the channels of trade with an irredeemable currency, and values of every description had enhanced with alarming rapidity. There were then only two incorporated banks in Dayton—the Miami Valley Bank and the Dayton Branch of the State Bank of Ohio—the Dayton Bank having sold out its business and closed its doors. Three private banks, however, or as they were then not infrequently called, "shaving shops," did the bulk of the business. These were conducted by Joel O. Shoup, Daniel Beckel, and Harshman & Winters. The last named succeeded to a large

portion of the business of the Dayton Bank, and it was my good fortune to be connected with them.

"The Dayton Branch of the State Bank made collections, bought and sold exchange, received deposits, but paid no interest therefor, and loaned money at six per cent, the charter limit, but frequently received a higher rate by directing its impecunious customers to make their paper payable in New York, instead of here, so that when the note matured the maker would be compelled to pay the same in exchange or its equivalent. This would ordinarily give the bank an additional one per cent on its loan, which, under the high taxes of the "crowbar law" of that day, was no unimportant item, though it was claimed that such procedure was an indirect violation of the State Bank charter.

"The Dayton Branch was not the only bank to assist its profits in this way, and I venture the assertion that there was not a bank in Ohio which did not practice in the same school. Tradition tells us that its discount committee met but once a week, and that on these occasions the lives, characters and prospects of the borrower and his endorsers, and of their immediate friends and relatives underwent a searching examination. Be this

as it may, the old bank was a staunch ship, well-manned and ballasted, against which the waves of panic and business prostration beat harmlessly, a credit and help to our city, and a marvelous success in days when success meant something more than merely to succeed.

“The private banks were not so conservative. In the competition for business they were urged on by a generous but dangerous rivalry, and offered and paid to their depositors on daily balances, interest at the rate of six per cent per annum. As a consequence, there was gathered into their keeping a vast sum, for those times, of the idle money of the city and country. This, in turn, they loaned to their customers at rates varying from ten to twelve per cent, seldom more, seldom less, the difference in the rate indicating the grade of paper offered, and as the loanable money exceeded the legitimate wants of our city, outside paper, that is, paper from adjacent towns and cities, was in demand.

“As much of the outside paper which was offered and taken could not necessarily have been first-class, heavy losses followed from the portion still unpaid when the inflation bubble was punctured.

“I remember overhearing a conversation between the heads of our firm and Joel O. Shoup, a neigh-

boring banker. Mr. Shoup was trying to dispose of the paper of Gregory & Burnet, and Ezekiel Ross, of Cincinnati. As our firm hesitated about taking the paper, Mr. Shoup became somewhat excited, and bringing his fist down on the table with great force, exclaimed: "Winters, any man, having the money, who would not discount old Zeke Ross' paper, ought to be hanged." To avoid this alternative the paper was taken, and is still held by the purchasers.

"The ordinary rate for gold and New York exchange was one half of one per cent premium, buying, and one per cent selling; but, in times of great monetary excitement, it frequently ran much higher.

"Foreign collections, and checks and drafts on points outside of New York, Boston, Philadelphia, Baltimore, and Cincinnati, were charged for at rates gauged by the difficulties of collection. The New York and Cincinnati banks and bankers paid their correspondents interest on their daily balances at rates ranging from four to six per cent.

"During the following year (1854) the bubble of inflation burst, and "wild cat," "red dog," and other nondescript issues "went to the wall." The mention of these names recalls an incident which

occurred in the office of Harshman & Winters at this time that may be worth narrating.

"Some of the older citizens will remember John McCracken, then city editor of one of our daily papers. Whilst conversing with him at a time when the excitement about our currency was at its height, a farmer entered the bank, followed by a large, lean, and hungry-looking yellow dog. The dog stretched himself near the stove for a nap. The farmer, having finished his business, left the bank and closed the door after him with a slam. This woke the dog, and, missing his master, he sprang up, and without stopping to consider possible consequences, bolted directly through the plate glass of the front door, and, followed by a shower of glass, was last seen heading for Springfield at break-neck speed. McCracken, while fairly bursting with laughter, called out, 'How's that, John, for circulation? Yaller dog issue, isn't it?'

"All of the currency then afloat from Maine to Kentucky, that had any standing at all, was freely taken by the merchants, and the most of it deposited with the banks at par and the remainder was taken by them at a varying discount. The whole of it was then carefully sorted over, and that from New York, New Jersey, Baltimore,

Philadelphia and the New England States was forwarded to the New York correspondent and credited at an average discount of less than one half of one per cent including express charges.

"The currency of the nearer banks was turned into gold by bank runners, or "carpet baggers," as they were then called, and the gold was sold again to such of the banks of circulation as were short in their reserves.

"This proceeding was a source of considerable profit to the bankers and brokers engaged in it, and it was more than hinted that even some of the banks of circulation lent a helping hand in the business. Cincinnati was a sort of central clearing house, and through her bankers, assisted by banks and bankers to a greater or less degree throughout the country, large amounts of Ohio, Indiana, Kentucky, and Virginia currency were returned to their places of issue for redemption. This had a salutary effect upon the banks, as it kept them constantly on their guard, and, as the clouds lowered in the financial horizon, the more conservative strengthened themselves to meet the coming storm.

"The State of Indiana had, a few years prior to this, passed a free banking law based upon a deposit with the auditor of State of the bonds of

Indiana, and of the other States of the Union in good repute. Any person, or any number of persons, by making the deposit aforesaid and selecting a point in Indiana for the redemption of the proposed issue, would be entitled to receive from the said auditor of State currency for circulation to an amount equal to the sum of the bonds pledged. Then by using the currency so received in the purchase of more bonds, the same operation could be repeated, and so on indefinitely.

“Memory recalls a bank near the borders of Ohio, which began with a small capital, and by this method of repeating secured a circulation of eight hundred thousand dollars. No doubt but that the owner thought he had a bonanza. The bonds drew forty-eight thousand dollars a year interest, while the expenses and cost of redemption were small. There was one factor, however, which he left out of his calculations, and that was the day when he would be called on to redeem his promises. When it came, it came as the storm comes, and the whole structure, so carefully built up, was swept into irretrievable ruin.

“Such a state of affairs, with a new bank or more springing into existence with each succeeding day, could not always continue.

"Cincinnati bankers, discovering how unready and unwilling these stock banks were to redeem their issues, and realizing how weak the system was, took the 'bull by the horns' and refused to receive, or pay out at par, the issues of Indiana stock banks. This was the beginning of the end, and in a few short months this class of money was completely blotted out.

"The bank messenger was the 'carpet bagger' of that day. It became his duty to follow up these 'will o' the wisp' banks and procure in exchange for their circulating notes, gold and silver, or other current bank notes. When a bank failed to redeem its pledges, due notice of such failure was given to the auditor of the State of Indiana, and as long as the bonds deposited were above par, he would sell them and redeem the outstanding circulation. But, when the bonds in his hands fell below par, as the most of them did, he adopted the policy of giving out the bonds of each particular bank in exchange for the currency of said bank, when presented in sums of one thousand dollars, or its multiple. As a banker might have many thousands of dollars of stock bank paper and yet not a thousand of a kind in the whole lot, another class of individuals stepped in who made it their

business to travel from bank to bank and make these exchanges. Jared M. Trader, a citizen of Dayton, lately deceased, engaged in this business in a small way.

"The life of the 'carpet bagger' was not an easy one, as I can testify from personal experience. To one carrying money about the country in large sums, danger from robbery was not nearly so great then as it is now, but much staging had to be done over corduroy roads, and others where the depth of the mud seemed fathomless, and in a country where everyone seemed to instinctively understand your errand. From Terre Haute to Vincennes it was a night ride, strapped under the tarpaulin on the top of a stage coach, with the stars of heaven for a canopy, and a grip-sack, filled with stock bank promises and an Allen revolver, for a pillow. I did not then know how dangerous the old 'pepper box' was, or I should not have slept on it. At Peru I was awakened by a great clatter at the door at midnight, and a ponderous voice calling out: 'Are you one of those blanked Cincinnati brokers?' On receiving my trembling assurances to the contrary, the voice departed with mutterings by the way. The owner of the voice, the landlord informed me in the morning, was the president of

the bank, whose headquarters were supposed to be located in a hollow stump near Wabash. These 'hollow stump banks,' and there were plenty of them in Indiana, were those which had merely a legal existence, but not enough of local habitation to be found by a search warrant. The pungent odor of the wild thyme, and the fragrance of the honeysuckle may have lingered about that 'bank,' but it is evident that the seductive and all-satisfying 'drops' from 'Uncle Sam's mint' found no lodgment there.

"At Logansport, in place of coin I got curses, and plenty of them, and in Michigan City a great scare. Arriving there at a late hour on an exceedingly dark night, I entered the hotel nearest the station, whose appearance was not at all prepossessing, but I was too tired to look further. Shortly after retiring I heard some one fumbling at my door; then all was quiet for a time, and then the quiet was succeeded by a tremendous racket. Verily, I thought that my time had come. How that old 'Allen' shook as I grasped it; my very hair stood on end.

"As the tumult subsided, I found that it was only the landlord trying to introduce a late guest through my room to an adjoining chamber. With

the best grace I could command under the circumstances, I admitted them and then found, to my dismay, that there was no means of fastening the door which separated our rooms. You may imagine how little I slept that night, as I lay there facing that door with my grip-sack in one hand, and that old 'pepper box' in the other.

"These personal recollections I have given you to enable you to form an idea of some of the difficulties of banking in 1854.

"In 1856 Harshman & Gorman commenced business as private bankers, and early in 1857 the firm of Harshman & Winters was merged into that of V. Winters & Son.

"In August, 1857, the Ohio Life Insurance and Trust Company, of Cincinnati, with a New York branch, failed in consequence of the misdoings of the cashier of the New York branch. A panic set in, and there were great losses and much distress throughout the country, but the banks and bankers of Dayton successfully breasted the storm. In 1860 the banking firm of Harshman & Co. was formed, which, in 1863, was merged into the Second National Bank, with Jonathan Harshman as president and David C. Rench as cashier, which, in turn, in 1883, was merged into the Third National

Bank, with W. P. Huffman as president and C. E. Drury as cashier.

"In 1863 the First National Bank was organized, with S. Gebhart as president and G. B. Harman as cashier, and after a short but successful career was closed to give place to the private bank of Gebhart, Harman & Co., which, in turn, in 1883, was merged into the City National Bank.

"At the close of 1864, the Dayton Branch of the State Bank was merged into the Dayton National Bank.

"In 1871 the Merchants' National Bank was established with D. E. Mead as president and A. S. Estabrook as cashier.

"On the first of January, 1882, the private bank of V. Winters & Son, after an existence of nearly twenty-five years, was re-organized as the Winters National Bank, with J. H. Winters as president and J. C. Reber as cashier.

"In the early part of January of this present year, the Fourth National Bank opened its door, with J. B. Thresher as president and Ziba Crawford as cashier. The Dayton Savings Bank, with L. H. Pooch as president and E. Pape as cashier, is the only bank now in Dayton outside the National Bank system.

"The gross capital of the Dayton banks is two millions of dollars. The surplus fund is two hundred and sixty-eight thousand dollars, and undivided profits about one hundred thousand dollars, making a total of capital and surplus of two million three hundred and sixty-eight thousand dollars.

"The deposits amount to about three million dollars. In 1853 the entire capital of the Dayton banks was two hundred thousand dollars, and the deposits were about one million four hundred thousand, so that in thirty-five years the banks have increased their capital ten-fold, while the deposits have little more than doubled.

"As we contemplate the vast increase in the material growth of the banks of our city, together with such other convincing evidences of prosperity as greet our eyes on every side, the smoking manufactories, the substantial business blocks, the many, very many, beautiful and well-ordered homes, and the quiet air of prosperity which pervades our people, may we not hope that, with the inauguration of this board of trade, we are entering on an era of prosperity that shall be lasting, and upon a higher plane than before, and that we are becoming mentally, physically, and morally a better people?

XVI.

Eight days later, March 1, 1888, Valentine Winters issued invitations for his children and two of his grandchildren (the representatives of his deceased daughters, Eliza and Clara) to join him in partaking of a family dinner. These invitations were, of course, accepted with alacrity, in view of former feasts at the same table when the dessert consisted of something more substantial than cake and ice-cream. The children and grandchildren present were Mrs. S. H. Darst, Mrs. M. J. Dickey, Mr. J. H. Winters, Mrs. Kate W. Gunckel, Mrs. L. W. Reber, Mrs. A. W. Shaw, and Mr. Horace McDermont. Mr. V. W. Eaton, being away at school, was only a participant by proxy.

The guests had all assembled in the small parlor and were enjoying a social chat when, promptly at five o'clock, the doors were thrown open leading to the dining-room, and they were led thither by the venerable host. A card at each chair designated who should be its occupant, and, as they took their seats, their eyes rested on plethoric and suspicious-looking packages lying next to the plates in front of them. After grace was said, Mr. Winters made

a short and touching address to his children in which he told them that his object in bringing them together was to make another division of a portion of his property, and explained the basis on which it was made, which he hoped would prove perfectly satisfactory to them all. He had made it on the basis of representation, that is, that the share of each one of his children should be greater or less in proportion to the number of their living children.

The conclusion of this kindly and loving address was followed by a long pause and then an earnest scrutiny of the sealed packages and of the numerals following the dollar mark. Then by a passing to and fro and comparison of packages with wonderings as to what the breaking of the seals would reveal. Then the dinner was eaten with a relish that only newly-made "Vanderbilts" can enjoy. It was a happy occasion, and no one seemed to enjoy it more heartily than the venerable host who realized that "it is more blessed to give than to receive." After the dessert was served, Mr. J. H. Winters arose and said, as the mouthpiece of the recipients of Mr. Winters' bounty:

DEAR FATHER:—It is again our privilege to assemble in the old homestead to renew our vows of fealty to you, our honored father, as the chieftain and head of our house.

History tells us that it was the custom of Eastern kings and potentates to call together the princes and nobility of their kingdom and distribute gifts and largesses among them to secure their loyalty; so you, to-day, have called about you the members of your family to give them a royal feast and to distribute gifts, not however, as did the Eastern kings, to secure loyalty, but that they might have this renewed evidence of your affection.

We rejoice that you are still permitted to be with us in the full enjoyment of health and all your faculties. We rejoice that, although eight decades have silvered your hair and deepened the furrows upon your brow, your years sit so lightly upon your shoulders that you are still enabled to enjoy life with a zest equal to that of either of your children.

To us you do not seem to grow old. The lightness of heart and elasticity of spirit which have characterized you throughout your life remain with you, in a measure, to-day, and point you out as the youngest of all the older men of our acquaintance, while the kindly, thoughtful, and thoroughly impartial manner in which you treat your children reveals in you, not only the loving father, but the wise counselor, the generous benefactor and the personal friend.

You it was, assisted by our precious mother, who enjoyed and encouraged our infant sports and guided and directed us through the perilous days of youth and over the threshold of manhood and womanhood. It was your kindly sympathy and helpful aid that still followed us on our paths diverging from the old homestead, when new duties and responsibilities fell to our lot, until now when with this crowning gift you overwhelm us with a renewed evidence of

your undying love. We shall not then wait till you have passed from our midst before we give expression to the sentiments of our hearts, but now, to-day, we desire to place the laurel wreath upon your brow, and to spread your pathway with the roses of affection, and to lay at your feet the sincere and loving tributes of grateful hearts.

Your measure of strength has permitted you to take your children's children, and their children upon your knees and to participate in and enjoy more than usually falls to the lot of man, and yet your eyes are not dimmed, nor are your natural forces abated. For this we give thanks to the great Giver of every good and perfect gift.

Having passed the eightieth mile-stone on the journey of life, and being seated as you are to-day, in the midst of your remaining children, what a flood of recollections must surge through your mind, as memory recalls the history of your life and spreads it out in panoramic view before you. Of your quiet life in Germantown when leisure and pleasure were equally scarce, of that journey to Cincinnati with a wagon load of flour to exchange for a ten plate stove, of the great fright and flight whilst camping on the high banks of the Ohio River, occasioned by the blowing-off of steam by a steamboat lying concealed under the bank; of the daily scenes witnessed in a clergyman's family, of your experience in the sugar camp, made especially acute from stepping into a pot of boiling syrup; of the hunt when the wild turkey, with trustful innocence, thought to hide himself by thrusting his head under the lower rail of a stake and rider fence; of the weary days spent in the brick yard and gymnastics required to steer clear of old Muley's hoofs; of the utter weariness of such a life and the growing ambition to do

something better; of the migration to Dayton and the apprenticeship in Irwin's store; of Mrs. Irwin's kindness; of your clerkship with Harshman & Rensch, and then, in spite of the proprieties, how you fell in love with and courted the fair Catharine, Mr. Harshman's second daughter, and of the happy marriage which followed.

What a halo of beauty surrounds the scene when the fair Catharine, "before God and these witnesses," surrendered her bright young life into your keeping "for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickness and in health until death do us part;" of the bridal party's notable ride to Germantown on horseback; of the birth of your first born, that wonderful event in the history of every family, to which all subsequent births shrink in importance by comparison; of the successive births that followed, until eleven souls were born to you, but only six of whom remain to this day; of the deaths of three of your boys, followed later by the dear partner of your joys and sorrows, our mother; and still later by two daughters, one so fragile, the other so strong. How like a dream all this must seem; a dream in which the pleasures of life are not unmingled with pain. Truly may we claim that yours has been a well-rounded life; that your "lines have fallen in pleasant places;" that the "goodly heritage" of the just man has been yours. Active and industrious as you have been in the pursuits of life, you have still found time to take an interest in everything tending towards the amelioration and elevation of those less fortunate than you, and when your country was in danger were among the first to proffer material aid, and later to contribute two sons to the army. It was your lot to be loyal in your country's

extremest need, when loyalty meant something more than sentiment.

Broad in your views and eminently philanthropic, your ear was ever open to hear, and your purse to respond to the calls of city, State, and church benevolence, and few there be of public enterprises in this vicinity which have not received from you a helping hand. Not confining yourself strictly to this life and its duties, you have ever been looking over and beyond its narrow confines to the life which lies beyond, and recognizing its appeals to your inner life, you have, with a child's unconscious innocence, submitted yourselves into the hands of a loving and merciful God. Shall we not, brothers and sisters, profit by the example of such a life and show to our father, while he is still with us, that we are not unmindful of his instructions? Shall we not take this life lesson to our hearts and strive to carry out its teaching in our lives, so that when we hear a voice down deep in our inner consciousness, as we shall all one day hear it, speaking those words so full of meaning, "Is it well with thy soul?" may we, one and all, be able to answer, "It is well, it is well."

After dinner, when the happy party had returned to the parlors, the seals of the various packages were broken and the "Oh's!" "How splendid!" "Oh, how nice!" responded from every side. A general rush was then made at Mr. Winters for a kiss and hug, and the wonder is how he managed to survive them all. In the aggregate the contents of the packages amounted

to five hundred thousand dollars in deeds, stocks, bonds, etc. This was Mr. Winters' "surprise dinner" to his guests. Could a greater relish be imagined? . At a late hour the fortunate guests of this "surprise dinner" departed for their several homes to spend the night in dreaming of houses, lands, stocks, bonds, and so on, *ad infinitum*.

Following in this line, Mr. Winters, in order that the public also, might enjoy somewhat of his benefactions, gave to the trustees of the Widows' Home, the Woman's Christian Association, and the Young Men's Christian Association, all of Dayton, Ohio, each the sum of five thousand dollars, to be held in perpetual trust and invested for said associations, the interest only to be used for their support.

An Ohio editor expresses his approval thus: "Valentine Winters, a Dayton millionaire, has given fifteen thousand dollars to worthy charities in that city. Shakespeare evidently had him in mind when he put in Cleopatra's mouth—

"For his bounty

There was no Winter in it: an Autumn 'twas
That grew the more by reaping.'

In remembrance, also, of his youth, spent in Germantown, he gave one thousand dollars to assist in establishing a public library there.

XVII.

What more pleasant method can be adopted to close this sketch of a useful and noble life than to ring it off with wedding bells? The high contracting parties are Valentine Winters, Jr., the only son of the only surviving son of the "Grand Old Man of the Miami Valley" (who has been the principal subject of this history), and Helen Wood Clegg. We will let Editor E. B. Grimes tell the story in his felicitous manner.

A NOTABLE WEDDING.

The marriage of Mr. Valentine Winters, Jr., to Miss Helen Clegg was a union of a son and daughter of two of the oldest and wealthiest families in the Miami Valley.

The real is more beautiful than the ideal. The face through which a true inner consciousness shines is more lovely than the most finished work of the artist. The faces of the mother and child, made by the old masters, as though to represent the light of heaven, are only reflections after all. How much more soulful and divine must have been the real! How much more of tenderness and love there must have been in the face of the real Mary

as she gazed upon the infant son of God, than any artist's brush has ever traced. Last night in Christ Episcopal Church one of the holiest of the Master's ordinances to man was solemnized.

"Those who were there will testify that the scene presented was more entrancingly beautiful than any wedding picture they have ever seen.

"The memory of the face of the bride with its remarkable purity and sweetness will never be erased from the minds of those present.

"Upon the front seat to the right sat representatives of four generations—representatives of a family whose prosperity and generosity form important chapters in the history of this community. These representatives were the venerable Valentine Winters, his son J. H. Winters, Mrs. Allen E. Thomas and her two children, Olive and Winters. To the left of them and the distinguished relatives and friends behind, sat the venerable grandfather and grandmother of the bride, Mr. and Mrs. Joseph Clegg, and their descendants and family connections.

"The altar was decorated with tropical plants, ascension lilies, and a large basket of bridal roses. To the right and left stood a large bronze and silver pillar, upon which rested candelabras, the

radiance from which lighted up the altar and chancel with beautiful effect. Just before the bridal party appeared Miss Ella Brussman sang Keble's Wedding Hymn, as set to music by Professor W. L. Blumenschein. Upon the appearance of the bridal party, and during its procession to the altar, the wedding march from Lohengrin was sung by the choir of the Third Street Presbyterian Church, Misses Brussman and Spindler, and Messrs. Branaman and Hessler, under the direction of Professor Blumenschein.

"The bridal party formed at the left rear door of the church, and proceeded to the altar in the following order:

"The ushers, Messrs. Robert Dickey, Jr., Charlie Reynolds, Charlie Simms, Chal. Graves, Charlie Wood, and Harry Clegg. Then came the bridesmaids, Miss Mary Kilgour, of Cincinnati, attired in a white gauze dress; Miss Bertha Platt and Miss Charlotte Thruston, in Greek costumes of white gauze. They carried bouquets of lilies of the valley. The maid of honor, Miss Clara Winters, sister of the groom, was attired in a dress of white corded silk, made *en train*, and she carried a bouquet of pink bridal roses.

"The bridesmaids and the maid of honor also

wore gold brooches, divided into squares, bearing raised forget-me-nots in colors. These were gifts from the bride. The gentlemen of the bridal party were given pearl scarf-pins by the groom. The pins were made to order, and like the gifts of the bride, were exquisite in workmanship.

"The bride, Miss Helen Clegg, leaning on the arm of her father, Mr. Charles B. Clegg, was attired in a dress of white corded silk, embroidered with pearl passementerie. She wore a bridal veil and carried in her hands a prayer book and a point lace handkerchief of historic as well as of intrinsic value. It was purchased by Grandmother Winters; was carried by her at her daughter's (Mrs. Shaw's) wedding, by Mrs. Allen E. Thomas at her wedding, and last night by Mrs. Valentine Winters, Jr. It belongs to Mrs. J. H. Winters. The bride's ornaments were a star-shaped diamond pendant, gift of her brother, Harry; a pearl pendant of the same shape, gift of her father, and a gold diamond-set, and blue enameled brooch, gift of the groom. The diamond star was worn in her hair, the brooch at her throat, and the pearl star at the corsage. When the bride and her father reached the altar, they were met by the groom, Mr. Valentine Winters, Jr., attended by his best man, Mr. Harvey

Conover, Jr. Within the chancel railing was the rector of Christ Church, Rev. Herbert J. Cook, who, in tones plainly audible in all portions of the church, performed the full wedding and ring service of the Episcopal ritual. The Lord's Prayer was chanted at the conclusion by the choir, and as the bridal party left the altar and church, the Metropolitan Orchestra played Mendelssohn's wedding march.

"In the church were over one thousand guests. A canopy, carpeted from the street to the church doors, gave entrance and egress to the large and distinguished assemblage.

"At the reception about four hundred guests enjoyed the generous hospitality of the father of the bride, given after the church services. Both the handsome Clegg and Captain E. Morgan Wood residences were arranged for the reception. They were connected by a substantial canopy decorated with flags and bunting, and illuminated with gas jets. The bride and groom received congratulations in the library of the Clegg residence under an arch of trailing smilax and white bridal roses. All the while the Metropolitan Orchestra discoursed its music behind a screen of tropical plants and smilax in the front hallway. Supper

was served in the Wood residence, the bridal table being spread in the front parlor. It was decorated with large white roses and a few of the almost unnumbered presents received.

"When the bridal cake was cut and distributed to the happy party, the ring, meaning a life of wedded happiness, and the next of the company to marry, was received by Miss Charlotte Thruston. The thimble, meaning to the recipient a life of single blessedness, was received by Miss Bertha Platt. The bean, meaning good luck and happiness, was received by Mr. Charles Reynolds, and the piece of money, meaning riches, was received by Miss Mary Schenck. About the different tables were representatives of the best-known and richest families of this Miami Valley. It is seldom that two such handsome grandfathers as Mr. Valentine Winters, Sr., and Mr. Joseph Clegg are present to be congratulated at a wedding. They were among the happiest of the happy company. Pleasant references were made to their own weddings in the days when a bridal tour on horseback was considered one of the greatest of enjoyments that the purses of the times could afford. All rejoiced at the presence of the groom's father, Mr. J. H. Winters, who had been quite ill during the past two weeks.

"At eleven o'clock guests still remained, loath to leave the charming surroundings. At midnight the bride and groom left for Chicago, where, after remaining a few days, they will go to their ranch home near Santa Barbara, California.

"The bride is the only daughter of Mr. Charles B. Clegg. Since the death of her mother (who was a Miss Pease), which sad event occurred when she was quite a child, she has been her father's almost constant companion. During her school days her father paid her frequent visits and the vacations have been spent in traveling together. During one of these vacation trips two years ago, at West Point, Mrs. Winters met Mr. George W. Childs, the world-wide known editor and philanthropist of Philadelphia. Like all who met her, then Miss Helen Clegg, he admired her. Later she and her father were guests at Mr. Child's famous country home. In parting with her he gave her an elegant gold watch and chain to remember her visit, and said, "When you are married, I will, if possible, attend your wedding." Temporary illness prevented Mr. Childs from coming. To her friends Mrs. Winters has always been the personification of all that is sweet, charitable, and lovable. She has undoubtedly been the most beautiful and widely-

loved young lady of the best social circles of this city since her entrance into society. Her face is the beautiful index of a disposition that is all that is winsome and gracious. As a bride she was indescribably lovely. In her wedding attire at the church she fulfilled the old historic verse, that a bride should wear:

"Something old
And something new,
Something borrowed
And something blue."

"By remembering the mention above of the historic handkerchief and blue enameling upon the brooch given her by her husband, it will be seen how the poet's conditions were fulfilled. She is a member of Christ Episcopal Church.

"The groom, Mr. Valentine Winters, Jr., is the only son of Mr. and Mrs. J. H. Winters. After receiving his education he was connected for a time with Winters' National Bank. His health being somewhat impaired, he went to California and purchased a ranch near Santa Barbara. After making some improvements upon his property he came home to visit his parents. He had previously been engaged to Miss Clegg. A few weeks ago the young people decided to fulfill their betrothal. The

wedding day was set for yesterday—and a glorious day it proved to be—a harbinger of their future life, all sincerely hope, who know them. It has been announced before that the groom's father recently gave him and his two sisters, Mrs. Thomas and Miss Clara, each fifty thousand dollars. The magnificent gifts of the father prove the confidence he has in a son, who has always been a worthy representative of the name he bears. He is a handsome, intelligent-looking young man, manly in his presence and address, and besides is, in family connections, one of the most notable young men of the city. "They are in every way suited to each other," was repeated a number of times last evening of the bride and groom.

"Besides the fifty thousand dollar gift from the father of the groom and the bridal ornaments mentioned was a check to the bride for a large sum from Mr. and Mrs. J. H. Winters, father and mother of the groom. Mr. and Mrs. Joseph Clegg, grandparents of the bride, also gave a check to her of like amount as the one referred to as a gift from Mr. and Mrs. Winters. Mr. George W. Childs accompanied his letter of regret by a toilet set, the back of every piece being of gold. Presents of gold and silver ware, cut glass pieces, Royal Wor-

cester china ware and French glass, vases, clocks, and bric-a-brac of almost every description were received. The presents, outside of the gifts of the checks, are worth a fabulous sum.

"The bridal favors were hand-painted white and gold satin ribbons, the painting being that of Mr. Harvey Conover, Jr., a cousin of the bride.

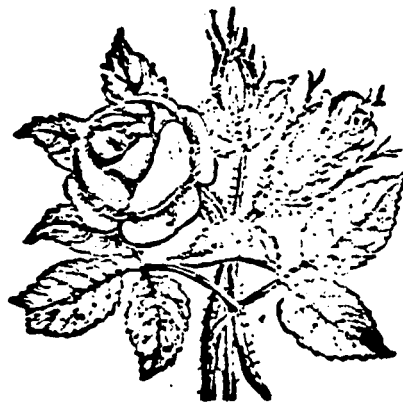
"As the bride was bidding good-bye to her relatives and guests, she threw from one of the hall balconies on the second floor to the guests below, the bridal flowers that had been suspended from the arch under which congratulations had been received. The flowers were caught by Miss Bertha Platt, and quite a good deal of merriment was enjoyed over the fact that while Miss Platt had received the thimble, as already noted, indicating a life of single blessedness, she had also received the bridal bouquet, indicating that she would be the next bride.

"Besides the well-known members of the family connection already mentioned were a long list of the best known citizens of Dayton. Among some of the beautiful costumes was the dress of Mrs. J. H. Winters, mother of the groom, a pale blue brocade. Mrs. Captain E. Morgan Wood, aunt of the bride, wore a white brocade; Mrs. Joseph

Clegg, the venerable grandmother of the bride, wore a black silk; Mrs. Allen E. Thomas, sister of the groom, wore a green corded silk with white satin front, made *en train*; Mrs. J. Henry Edgar, of New York, cousin of the bride, wore a white corded silk, with pearl and gold trimmings; Mrs. Mahala Westerman, aunt of the bride, wore black silk; Mrs. Torrence Huffman wore a white silk trimmed in point lace. There were many other costumes of almost equal beauty. Of the older members of the Harshman branch of the Winters family present were Mrs. S. H. Beckel and Mr. Geo. W. Harshman. Among the guests from out of the city were Mr. and Mrs. John Kilgour, Mr. and Mrs. Albert G. Clark, Miss Mary Kilgour, Mr. Holden Davis, Rev. and Mrs. T. O. Lowe, Cincinnati; Miss Nora Lowe, Mr. and Mrs. E. C. Shaw, Toledo; Col. Charles Parrott, Miss Bessie Parrott, Columbus; Mrs. Beck and Miss Munroe, Boston; Miss Loomis, Hartford, Conn.; Miss Lucy McCook, Fort Leavenworth; Mrs. J. Henry Edgar, New York; Mrs. Judge White, Springfield; Mrs. Wait, Mr. Pomeroy and Miss Ida Pomeroy, Indianapolis; Miss Tranchant, Osborn; Miss Curwen, Maysville; Miss Parker, Somerset, Pa.

A congratulatory telegram was received from

Hon. Lewis B. Gunckel, wife and daughter, Miss Kittie, uncle, aunt, and cousin of the groom, who are spending the winter in southern California. A box of the rarest flowers grown in the Golden State were from Mr. Winters' ranch, sent by a friend.



XVIII.

However loath we may be to leave a subject so interesting in all of its details, the time has come for the "curtain to drop." Our father, the patriarch of the family, is still in our midst, and, with his happy disposition and cordial manners, is at once the life and sunshine of all family gatherings. His "children rise up and call" him "blessed," and his children's children "they praise him."

Though fast approaching his eighty-third year, he is still hearty and vigorous and bears his great age with dignity and cheerfulness. As editor of these papers, we have stood by his cradle and watched over his youth and young manhood, participated in his marriage festivities, and followed him through a long, active, and honorable business career, have rejoiced with him over the birth and marriage of his children, and with uncovered head and bated breath, have helped him to bury his dead; have found him loving, kind-hearted, and faithful in all the duties of life, and loyal to his friends, his country, and his God. And now we leave him, still retaining in his old age the respect and esteem of all who know him.

May, 1889.

